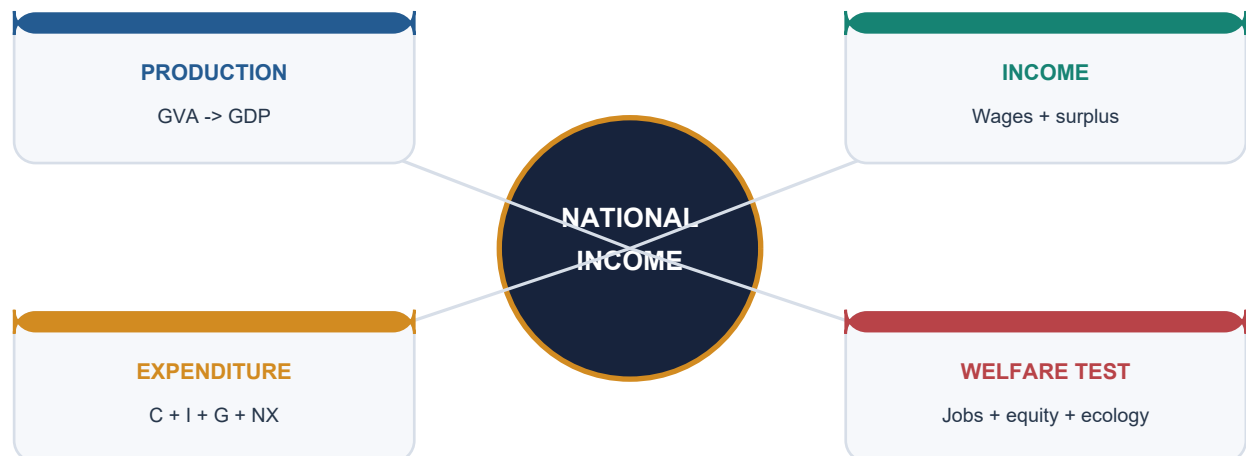


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Deterministic fallback visual: national income viewed through production, income, expenditure and welfare lenses.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Polity 17 - Parliament - Complete Topic Package

Subject: Indian Polity | **Topic:** 17 | **GS-II + Prelims** | **Export date:** 2026-08-16 **Approval:** false - awaiting explicit user approval. **Evidence key:** [FACT] constitutional, judicial or officially verified proposition; [ANALYSIS] reasoned exam synthesis; [CURRENT] dated live control; [LIMIT] qualification preventing overstatement.

Package method, source priority and current control

- Source order followed: authoritative Core owner Polity/basic/Parliament.md -> optional procedural depth in Polity/advanced/17_Parliament.md -> cross-links in Polity 11, Polity 16, basic/Anti-Defection-Law.md, basic/Election-Commission.md, basic/Amendment-and-Basic-Structure.md and basic/President-and-Vice-President.md -> dated official controls. Qdrant was not used.
- [LIMIT] Foundation/Core below is independently answer-complete. Optional Advanced adds deeper doctrine and answer refinement; no examination answer depends on opening it.
- [CURRENT] Status is controlled to **16 August 2026, Asia/Kolkata**.
- [CURRENT] **Digital Sansad** is the official control for debates, Bills and committee activity. Its Lok Sabha debate record shows that the **8th Session of the 18th Lok Sabha was adjourned sine die on 13 August 2026**. No unsupported productivity percentage, sitting total or Bill count is used here.
- [CURRENT] The official PIB overview of the **7th Session** is available at <https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2026/apr/doc2026418851201.pdf>. It is retained as an official session source, not converted here into unverified statistics.
- [CURRENT] The **Constitution (One Hundred and Sixth Amendment) Act, 2023 commenced on 16 April 2026**, but the women's reservation is **not operational**. This package preserves the exact enacted -> commenced -> operational distinction.
- [CURRENT] Census 2027 conduct and reference dates are notified, but the date on which the relevant figures will be **published**, the date of delimitation and the date on which reservation will operate are all unknown.
- [CURRENT] The Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill, Delimitation Bill and Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026 were introduced on 16 April 2026. The constitutional amendment was defeated on 17 April 2026 despite a 298:230 division among 528 members present and voting. They are treated only as **defeated Bills**, never as law, precedent or forecast.
- [CURRENT] No visible final decision on the larger-Bench Article 110 issue referred in *Rojer Mathew* was located on the official Supreme Court judgment portals as of 16 August 2026. The status is therefore stated narrowly and qualified.
- Package standard delivered: more than 20 text-native visuals, eight solved Mains PYQs, all 20 routed Prelims demands, 36 original MCQs, 12 remedial MCQs and seven original solved Mains questions.

Roadmap

Stage	Coverage	Exam outcome
Architecture	Article 79, bicameral design and constitutional supremacy	Defines Parliament correctly
Houses	Composition, election, terms and seat ceilings	Solves repeated Prelims traps
Representation	Delimitation, freeze, Census 2027 and 2026 Bills	Handles the live federal issue
Membership	Qualifications, disqualifications, office of profit and LoP	Connects Articles 84, 102 and 103
Time and devices	Sessions, quorum, questions, motions and notices	Explains daily accountability
Chairs and privilege	Speaker, Deputy Speaker, Chairman and <i>Sita Soren</i>	Answers institutional-neutrality demands
Law-making	Bill classes, stages, joint sitting and lapse	Builds complete legislative procedure
Public finance	Budget, grants, Bills and constitutional funds	Explains the power of the purse
Oversight	Questions, motions, audit and committees	Evaluates executive accountability
Bicameralism	Rajya Sabha equality, inequality and Articles 249/312	Produces a graded second-chamber verdict
Political incentives	Anti-defection, executive dominance and decline	Moves from text to institutional analysis
Reform and diplomacy	Reforms, IPG, IPU and CPA	Adds conclusion-ready value
Practice	PYQs, MCQs, remedials and Mains models	Converts knowledge into marks

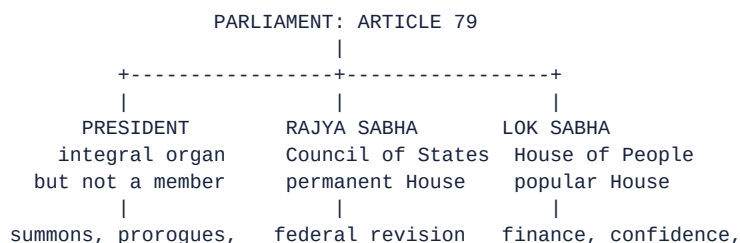
Scope ownership and cross-links

- **Polity 11 - Parliamentary System:** fusion of powers, collective responsibility, parliamentary versus presidential government and cabinet dominance.
- **Polity 16 - PM and Council of Ministers:** Article 75(3), executive coordination, cabinet control of the agenda and the 2024 GS-II cabinet-growth route.
- **Anti-Defection Law:** Tenth Schedule grounds, Speaker as tribunal, judicial review and whip reform.
- **Election Commission:** Article 103 decisions, RPA disqualifications and election-petition routes.
- **Amendment and Basic Structure:** Article 368 procedure, State ratification and the absence of joint sitting.
- **President and Vice-President:** summoning, prorogation, dissolution, assent, ordinance and the Rajya Sabha Chair.
- [LIMIT] Cross-links prevent duplication, but every Parliament-specific rule required for Prelims and GS-II is complete in Part I.

PART I - Complete Foundation and Core learning session

01. Article 79 architecture: what Parliament constitutionally is

Visual 1 - Tripartite architecture



- [FACT] Article 79 creates Parliament as the **President + Council of States + House of the People**.
- [FACT] The President is not a member of either House but is indispensable to summoning, prorogation, address and assent.
- [ANALYSIS] Bicameralism divides democratic authority: Lok Sabha supplies direct popular legitimacy; Rajya Sabha supplies continuity, revision and a State-based federal voice.
- [LIMIT] India borrowed responsible parliamentary government, not British parliamentary sovereignty. A written Constitution, federal distribution, Fundamental Rights, judicial review and the basic-structure doctrine bind Parliament.

Core thesis: Indian Parliament is politically central but legally constituted and limited.

02. Composition, election, term and seat ceilings

Visual 2 - Two-House comparison matrix

Dimension	Rajya Sabha	Lok Sabha
Constitutional ceiling	[FACT] 250 : up to 238 elected + 12 nominated	[FACT] 550 : up to 530 States + 20 UTs
Current sanctioned/elected strength supported by Core	[FACT] 245 sanctioned	[FACT] 543 elected
Election	Indirect; elected State/eligible UT representatives through proportional representation by single transferable vote	Direct; territorial constituencies through first-past-the-post and universal adult suffrage
Nominated members	12 nominated by President for special knowledge/practical experience in literature, science, art and social service	None; Anglo-Indian nomination ceased after the 104th Amendment
Nature	Permanent; never dissolved	Normally five years; may be dissolved earlier
Individual term	Six years; roughly one-third retire every second year	House-wide term; members face dissolution together
Minimum age	30 years	25 years

Visual 3 - Election routes

RAJYA SABHA

State elected MLAs -> proportional representation -> STV -> elected RS member
 |
 +-> open ballot under the RPA change of 2003

LOK SABHA

Eligible voters -> territorial constituency -> FPTP plurality -> elected MP

- [FACT] The 2003 removal of the Rajya Sabha candidate's State-domicile requirement and introduction of the open ballot came through amendment of the **Representation of the People Act, 1951**, not a constitutional amendment; *Kuldip Nayar v. Union of India* (2006) upheld it.
- [FACT] Lok Sabha's normal term under Article 83 is five years from its first meeting. During a national emergency Parliament may extend it by law for one year at a time, but not beyond six months after the emergency ends.
- [FACT] Rajya Sabha continuity means the whole Union legislature never disappears.
- [LIMIT] "Working strength" can vary with vacancies. The stable exam facts are the ceilings, 245 sanctioned Rajya Sabha strength supported by Core and 543 elected Lok Sabha seats.

Visual 4 - Continuity clock

Rajya Sabha: [1/3 retires]----2 years----[1/3 retires]----2 years----[1/3]

Member term: <----- 6 years ----->

Lok Sabha: first meeting ----- normally 5 years ----- dissolution

03. Representation, delimitation and the seat-freeze bargain

Visual 5 - Constitutional timeline

1952	1962	1972	1976	2001	2003	after 2026
Delimitation Commission published Acts	Delimitation Commission Acts	Delimitation Commission Acts	42nd Amdt freezes allocation	84th Amdt extends freeze	87th Amdt boundaries on 2001 data	first census figures -> readjustment

2002 Delimitation Commission: fourth all-India commission

Jammu and Kashmir after 2019: distinct statutory exercise, not a fifth all-India cycle

- [FACT] Article 81(2)(a) seeks, so far as practicable, a similar population-to-seat ratio among States; Article 170 carries the parallel Assembly principle.
- [FACT] The **42nd Amendment (1976)** froze inter-State seat allocation on the 1971 Census basis; the **84th Amendment (2001)** extended readjustment until the relevant figures of the first census taken after 2026 are published; the **87th Amendment (2003)** permitted constituency-boundary readjustment on 2001 data without altering State seat totals.
- [ANALYSIS] The freeze rewarded population-control performance by preventing successful States from immediately losing relative political weight.
- [FACT] Article 82 links post-census readjustment to an authority Parliament determines; Delimitation Acts establish commissions. Article 329(a) insulates delimitation law and allotment from judicial challenge.
- [LIMIT] The freeze does not “expire automatically in 2026”. Publication of the relevant post-2026 census figures is the textual gate.
- [LIMIT] No post-freeze State-wise seat allocation, new House strength or women's-seat count exists in law.

Visual 6 - The federal dilemma

Population proportionality

```
|
+--> gives equal weight to equally sized populations
|
+--> may reduce relative power of low-growth States
      |
      +--> Rajya Sabha is also population-weighted,
            not equal-per-State like the US Senate
      |
      +--> possible federal bargaining shock
```

Balanced answer: democratic equality claim <-> demographic-performance fairness claim

04. Qualifications, disqualifications and vacancies

Visual 7 - Membership gate

QUALIFY (Article 84)	REMAIN QUALIFIED (Article 102)
Citizen of India	no disqualifying office of profit
Oath/affirmation as prescribed	not declared of unsound mind by court
Age: 30 RS / 25 LS	not an undischarged insolvent
Other qualifications by Parliament	no foreign citizenship/allegiance
	no statutory disqualification
v	no Tenth Schedule disqualification
valid candidature	
	v
	Article 103: President decides, after obtaining ECI opinion

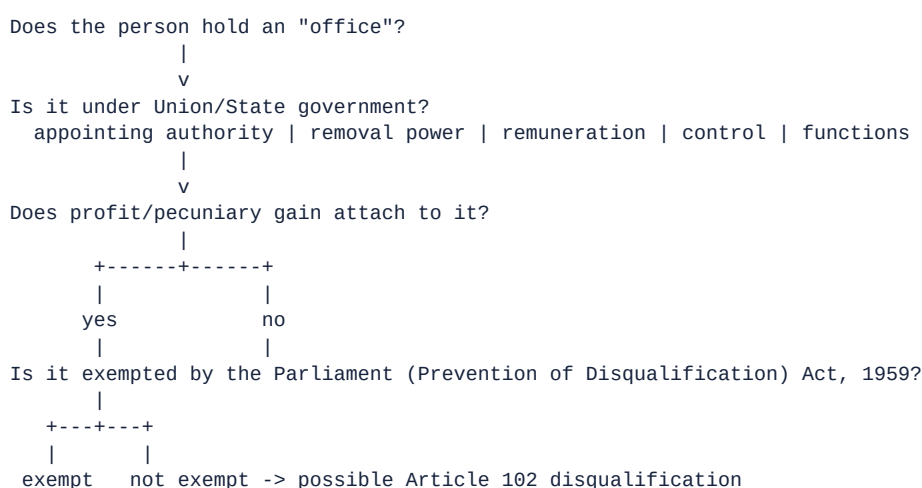
- [FACT] Article 84 supplies constitutional qualifications; Parliament adds statutory qualifications through election law.
- [FACT] Article 102(1) lists office of profit, court-declared unsoundness of mind, undischarged insolvency, loss/acquisition of citizenship or foreign allegiance and disqualification under parliamentary law. Article 102(2)

adds Tenth Schedule defection.

- [FACT] RPA 1951 grounds include specified convictions, corrupt practices, dismissal for corruption/disloyalty, government contracts, office under a government company and failure to lodge election-expense accounts.
- [FACT] *Lily Thomas v. Union of India* (2013) removed the former sitting-member shield in RPA section 8(4); a qualifying conviction can cause immediate disqualification. A stay of the **conviction**, not merely the sentence, is the relevant relief.
- [FACT] For a question whether a sitting member has incurred an Article 102(1) disqualification, Article 103 places the decision with the President, who must obtain the ECI's opinion.
- [LIMIT] Election validity is challenged through an election petition in the High Court; it is not identical to the Article 103 sitting-member reference.

Office of profit

Visual 8 - Office-of-profit test



- [FACT] The office-of-profit rule protects legislative independence from executive patronage.
- [FACT] The **Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959** exempts specified offices; exemption is statutory and office-specific.
- [ANALYSIS] Courts use substance rather than label: appointment/removal, remuneration, control and governmental character matter.
- [LIMIT] "Office of profit" is not synonymous with every public office or every paid activity.

Vacancy and double membership

- [FACT] Article 101 governs vacation of seats, including simultaneous membership questions and prolonged absence without House permission.
- [FACT] A member may resign in writing to the Speaker/Chairman; the presiding officer may refuse to accept if not satisfied that resignation is voluntary or genuine.
- [FACT] The House may declare a seat vacant after absence for sixty days without permission, excluding periods specified by Article 101.

05. Leader of Opposition and opposition architecture

Visual 9 - Opposition distinctions

Institution	Legal/procedural character	Exam caution
Leader of Opposition	[FACT] Statutory office under the Salary and Allowances of Leaders of Opposition in Parliament Act, 1977	Recognition practice requires the relevant threshold; Core uses the one-tenth rule
Largest opposition party leader	Political fact	May exist even where no person is formally recognised as LoP

Institution	Legal/procedural character	Exam caution
Opposition party	Party outside government	Do not equate every opposition party with the "official opposition"
Committee chair from Opposition	Convention in specified context, notably PAC	Not a universal rule for all committees

- [FACT] Core records that recognised LoP status requires a party with at least one-tenth of the House; the 16th and 17th Lok Sabhas had no recognised LoP.
- [LIMIT] For the 2018 Prelims historical demand, do not invent or casually assert the identity of the "first Lok Sabha opposition party" unless the precise official source/question wording is before you.
- [ANALYSIS] A recognised LoP matters beyond debate: statutes often place the office on selection committees, making recognition part of institutional checks.

06. Sessions, sittings, adjournment, prorogation and dissolution

Visual 10 - Time hierarchy

HOUSE TERM

```

|
+-- SESSION (summoned and prorogued by President)
    |
    +-- SITTING (opened, adjourned or adjourned sine die by presiding officer)

```

Adjournment -> pauses a sitting
Adjournment sine die -> ends a sitting without fixing the next date
Prorogation -> ends the session; pending Bills survive, notices usually lapse
Dissolution -> ends Lok Sabha itself; Rajya Sabha is never dissolved

- [FACT] Article 85 requires the President to summon each House so that six months do not intervene between the last sitting of one session and the first sitting of the next.
- [FACT] The rule guarantees at least two sessions in a year, not a constitutionally fixed "Budget-Monsoon-Winter" calendar and not a minimum number of sitting days.
- [FACT] Budget, Monsoon and Winter are conventional labels; they are not constitutional categories and should not be frozen as mandatory counts.
- [FACT] The President prorogues either House and dissolves the Lok Sabha; presiding officers adjourn sittings.
- [CURRENT] The 8th Session of the 18th Lok Sabha was adjourned sine die on **13 August 2026**. This is a dated event, not a rule about future session numbering or duration.

Visual 11 - Quorum and voting

Total House strength -> quorum = one-tenth under Article 100(3)

Lok Sabha: 550 ceiling -> Core recall figure 55
Rajya Sabha: 250 ceiling -> Core recall figure 25

Members present and voting decide ordinary questions
Presiding officer ordinarily does not vote -> casting vote only on a tie

- [FACT] If quorum is absent, the presiding officer must adjourn or suspend the meeting until quorum exists.
- [LIMIT] Vacancies do not invalidate House proceedings merely because seats are unfilled.

07. Questions, Zero Hour, discussions and motions

Visual 12 - Question taxonomy

Device	Reply	Supplementaries	Core use
Starred question	Oral	Yes	Live ministerial cross-examination
Unstarred question	Written	No	Detailed factual disclosure
Short-notice question	Oral, on urgent matter with shorter notice	Yes	Urgent accountability

Device	Reply	Supplementaries	Core use
Supplementary	Follow-up to oral answer	It is itself the follow-up	Tests and clarifies the minister's reply

- [FACT] Question Hour is rule-based. Zero Hour is an Indian parliamentary innovation conventionally dated to 1962 and is not formally in the Rules.
- [ANALYSIS] Written questions build an administrative record; oral supplementaries expose omissions in real time.

Visual 13 - Accountability ladder

INFORMATION

Questions -> Zero Hour -> Calling Attention -> Half-an-Hour Discussion

|

DEBATE AND CRITICISM

Short-Duration Discussion -> Censure Motion -> Adjournment Motion

|

FINANCIAL PRESSURE

Cut Motions -> refusal of supply

|

SURVIVAL

No-Confidence Motion in Lok Sabha

Device	Purpose	Key distinction
Calling Attention	Urgent matter of public importance; ministerial statement	Indian innovation; does not itself test confidence
Half-an-Hour Discussion	Clarifies a matter arising from an answer	Information-focused
Short-Duration Discussion	Debate without a formal vote	Discussion, not censure
Adjournment Motion	Interrupts normal business for a definite urgent matter; censures government	Lok Sabha; requires support of 50 members
Censure Motion	Condemns specified policy/action	Reasons must be stated; may target a minister/group/council
No-Confidence Motion	Tests whether the Council retains Lok Sabha confidence	No reasons required; support of 50 members for admission
Motion of Thanks	Responds to President's Address	Amendments may politically test government

- [FACT] Article 75(3) makes the Council of Ministers collectively responsible to the **Lok Sabha**, so the confidence key lies only there.
- [LIMIT] Rajya Sabha may criticise, question and defeat ordinary legislation, but cannot constitutionally remove the Union ministry through no-confidence.

08. Presiding officers: authority, continuity and neutrality

Visual 14 - Lok Sabha chair hierarchy

HOUSE ELECTS UNDER ARTICLE 93

|

+-----+

|

|

SPEAKER DEPUTY SPEAKER

|

|

rules, order, substitutes when Speaker absent;
Money Bill, answerable to House, not subordinate
joint sitting,
casting vote,
Tenth Schedule

Speaker

- [FACT] Articles 93-97 govern the Speaker and Deputy Speaker. The House elects them from among its members.
- [FACT] The Speaker vacates by ceasing to be a member, resigning to the Deputy Speaker or removal by a majority of **all the then members of the House** after fourteen days' notice.

- [FACT] The Speaker does **not** vacate on dissolution; Article 94 continues the office until immediately before the first sitting of the new Lok Sabha.
- [FACT] During consideration of the Speaker's removal resolution, Article 96 prevents the Speaker from presiding. The Speaker may speak and vote in the first instance but has no casting vote in that proceeding.
- [FACT] Major powers include maintaining order, interpreting House rules, certifying a Money Bill, presiding over a joint sitting, using a casting vote on a tie and deciding Tenth Schedule petitions subject to judicial review.
- [ANALYSIS] These powers make impartiality structural, not ceremonial.

Deputy Speaker

- [FACT] The Deputy Speaker is independently elected by the House; when presiding, the Deputy Speaker exercises the Speaker's powers and is answerable to the House.
- [FACT] Article 93 says the House shall, as soon as may be, choose a Speaker and Deputy Speaker but fixes no numerical deadline.
- [CURRENT] The post remained vacant throughout the **17th Lok Sabha (2019-2024)**.
- [LIMIT] This package does **not** assume or assert a present vacancy in the 18th Lok Sabha without a fresh official office-holder check.

Rajya Sabha Chairman and Deputy Chairman

- [FACT] Article 89 makes the Vice-President the ex-officio Chairman of Rajya Sabha; the Chairman is not a Rajya Sabha member.
- [FACT] The House elects a Deputy Chairman from among its members.
- [FACT] The Chairman ordinarily has no first-instance vote and uses a casting vote on equality under Article 100.
- [FACT] When a resolution for removal of the Vice-President is under consideration, Article 92 prevents the Chairman from presiding.

Visual 15 - Neutrality problem

High decisional powers
 Money Bill + discipline + debate + defection
 |
 Party-linked route to office
 |
 Perception of partisan incentive
 |
 Reforms: convention of detachment | timely rulings |
 reasoned decisions | independent defection tribunal

- [ANALYSIS] Britain's "once a Speaker, always a Speaker" convention is not followed in India: the Speaker retains a party-linked political career and contests elections.
- [LIMIT] Institutional risk does not prove that every ruling is partisan. A good answer distinguishes design vulnerability from allegations in a particular case.

09. Parliamentary privileges and the Sita Soren boundary

Visual 16 - Privilege shield

CORE PROTECTED ZONE	OUTSIDE THE SHIELD
Speech in House	bribery transaction
Vote in House	criminal act lacking functional nexus
Authorised parliamentary publication	mala fide exercise reviewable for illegality
Internal discipline and contempt powers	
+--> protection exists so Parliament can function, not to create a personal criminal immunity	

- [FACT] Article 105 protects freedom of speech in Parliament subject to the Constitution and House rules, and immunises members from court proceedings for speech or vote in Parliament.
- [FACT] Privileges belong to each House, its members and committees; breach of privilege violates a specific privilege, while contempt is wider conduct that obstructs House functions.

- [FACT] Privilege powers are not wholly beyond judicial review. *Raja Ram Pal v. Speaker, Lok Sabha* (2007) accepted review for substantive or procedural illegality while respecting legislative autonomy.
- [FACT] In **Sita Soren v. Union of India (2024)** a unanimous seven-judge Bench overruled *P.V. Narasimha Rao* (1998): a legislator who accepts a bribe for a vote or speech receives **no Article 105/194 immunity**; the bribery offence is complete on acceptance.
- [LIMIT] *Sita Soren* removed a bribery shield. It did not abolish ordinary immunity for bona fide parliamentary speech and votes.

Visual 17 - Case logic

```

Was the act a speech/vote forming part of legislative functioning?
|
yes ----- no
|           |
Article 105 immunity may attach   ordinary law applies
|
Was there a separate bribe agreement/acceptance?
|
yes -> Sita Soren: no privilege immunity for bribery

```

10. Legislative procedure for an ordinary Bill

Visual 18 - Five-stage route

```

FIRST READING
introduction and publication
|
SECOND READING
general discussion -> committee/reference -> clause-by-clause consideration
|
THIRD READING
final acceptance or rejection
|
SECOND HOUSE
pass | amend and return | reject | hold for six months
|
PRESIDENT: Article 111
assent | withhold | return once (if not a Money Bill)
|
If repassed: President cannot withhold assent

```

- [FACT] An ordinary Bill may originate in either House and may be introduced by a minister or private member.
- [FACT] Both Houses must agree to identical text.
- [FACT] The President may return a non-Money Bill once. If both Houses pass it again, with or without amendment, the President shall not withhold assent.
- [ANALYSIS] Committee reference is the point at which general policy becomes clause-level legal scrutiny.
- [LIMIT] Not every Bill is constitutionally required to go to a committee; making referral routine is a reform proposal.

11. Ordinary, Money, Financial and Constitution Amendment Bills

Visual 19 - Bill classification tree

```

Does the Bill contain ONLY Article 110(1)(a)-(g) matters and incidental matters?
|
yes -> MONEY BILL
|
no
v
Does it contain an Article 110 matter plus other matters?
|
yes -> FINANCIAL BILL-I: Article 117(1)
|
no
v
Would it involve expenditure from the Consolidated Fund?
|
yes -> FINANCIAL BILL-II: Article 117(3)
|

```

no -> ORDINARY BILL

Does it amend the Constitution? -> ARTICLE 368 CONSTITUTION AMENDMENT BILL

Visual 20 - Procedure comparison matrix

Feature	Ordinary Bill	Money Bill	Financial Bill-I	Financial Bill-II	Constitution Amendment Bill
Provision	General	Arts 109-110	Art 117(1)	Art 117(3)	Art 368
Origin	Either House	Lok Sabha only	Lok Sabha only	Either House	Either House
President recommendation	Not generally required for introduction	Required	Required	Required before consideration, not necessarily introduction	Not required
Rajya Sabha power	Equal	Recommend only; 14 days	Equal/full	Equal/full	Equal; must pass separately
Joint sitting	Possible	No	Possible	Possible	No
Speaker certificate	No	Yes	No Money Bill certificate	No	No
President may return	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	No; must assent after due passage

Money Bill firewall

- [FACT] Article 110 is exhaustive: a Bill is a Money Bill only if it contains **only** listed fiscal matters and incidental matters.
- [FACT] Article 109 gives Rajya Sabha fourteen days to recommend changes. Lok Sabha may accept or reject any recommendation; non-return within fourteen days results in deemed passage in Lok Sabha form.
- [FACT] Article 110(3) says the Speaker's decision is final, and the certificate is endorsed under Article 110(4).
- [LIMIT] Textual finality does not create absolute constitutional immunity. Judicial review remains narrow and is addressed in Optional Advanced.

Constitution Amendment Bill

- [FACT] It may begin in either House, must be passed separately by each House and has no joint-sitting escape.
- [FACT] The ordinary Article 368 special majority has two concurrent limbs: majority of total membership **and** two-thirds of members present and voting.
- [FACT] Amendments touching specified federal provisions also need ratification by at least half of State legislatures.
- [FACT] After valid passage the President must assent.

12. Joint sitting, legislative deadlock and Bill lapse

Visual 21 - Article 108 deadlock route

Ordinary/eligible Financial Bill
 |
 Second House rejects OR final disagreement OR holds > 6 months
 |
 President may notify intention to summon joint sitting
 |
 Speaker presides -> members present and voting decide
 |
 Numerical strength normally favours Lok Sabha

NO joint sitting: Money Bill | Constitution Amendment Bill

- [FACT] Only three joint sittings have occurred: Dowry Prohibition Bill (1961), Banking Service Commission (Repeal) Bill (1978) and Prevention of Terrorism Bill (2002).

- [LIMIT] Joint sitting is an available constitutional mechanism, not an automatic consequence of every disagreement.

Visual 22 - Lapse decision tree on Lok Sabha dissolution

Where is the Bill?

```

|
+-- pending in Lok Sabha -----> LAPSES
|
+-- passed by Lok Sabha, pending in Rajya Sabha -----> LAPSES
|
+-- pending in Rajya Sabha, not passed by Lok Sabha --> SURVIVES
|
+-- passed by both, awaiting President's assent -----> SURVIVES
|
+-- returned by President -----> SURVIVES
|
+-- joint sitting already notified -----> SURVIVES

```

- [ANALYSIS] Rajya Sabha permanence protects Bills that originate and remain pending there; dissolution cuts off business dependent on the expired Lok Sabha's will.
- [FACT] Prorogation does not cause Bills to lapse.

13. Budget, grants and the constitutional funds

Visual 23 - Budget sequence

Annual Financial Statement: Article 112

|
General discussion

|
DRSC scrutiny of ministry demands

|
Lok Sabha votes Demands for Grants: Article 113

| cut motions | guillotine at deadline

|
Appropriation Bill: Article 114 -> legal authority to withdraw

|
Finance Bill -> taxation proposals enacted

|
PAC-CAG post-expenditure audit closes the loop

- [FACT] The Constitution calls the budget the **Annual Financial Statement**.
- [FACT] Expenditure charged on the Consolidated Fund may be discussed but is not submitted to vote; other expenditure is voted through demands for grants.
- [FACT] Rajya Sabha may discuss the budget but only Lok Sabha votes demands for grants, on the President's recommendation.
- [FACT] **Policy Cut** reduces a demand to **Re 1**; Economy Cut specifies a reduction; **Token Cut** reduces it by **Rs 100** to ventilate a grievance.
- [FACT] The guillotine puts remaining undiscussed demands to vote at the scheduled deadline.
- [ANALYSIS] The budget demonstrates Lok Sabha primacy and also the accountability cost of limited House time.

Visual 24 - Grant toolkit

Device	Time and purpose	Trap
Vote on Account	Advance for ordinary expenditure pending full budget	Not a separate full budget
Vote of Credit	Unexpected demand of indefinite character, often emergency-like	Amount/details cannot be stated with ordinary precision
Exceptional Grant	Special purpose outside the current service	Distinct from routine annual service
Supplementary Grant	Authorised amount proves insufficient	In-year top-up
Additional Grant	Need arises for a new service not in budget	New service


```

|   +-- financial committees
|   +-- Department-related Standing Committees
|   +-- House/business committees
|   +-- inquiry/oversight committees
|
+-- AD HOC: end after assigned work
    |
    +-- Select/Joint Committees on Bills
    +-- Joint Parliamentary Committees for a specified inquiry

```

Not a parliamentary committee:
Consultative Committee chaired by a minister

Financial committees

Visual 28 - Financial trio

Committee	Exact composition	Chair/control	Function	Membership caution
Public Accounts Committee	22 = 15 LS + 7 RS	Opposition chair by convention since 1967	CAG reports, appropriation and financial regularity	Ministers barred; ordinarily does not question policy itself
Estimates Committee	30, Lok Sabha only	Ruling-party chair	Economy, efficiency and alternative policy/administrative arrangements in estimates	No Rajya Sabha members; ministers barred
Committee on Public Undertakings	22 = 15 LS + 7 RS	Chair from Lok Sabha	Reports/accounts of public undertakings	Ministers barred

- [ANALYSIS] The trio divides time: Estimates looks forward, PAC audits backward and CoPU specialises by institutional form.

Department-related Standing Committees

- [FACT] The system began with **17 committees in 1993** and was restructured to **24 from 2004**.
- [FACT] Each DRSC has **31 members: 21 Lok Sabha + 10 Rajya Sabha**; **16** are serviced by the Lok Sabha Secretariat and **8** by the Rajya Sabha Secretariat.
- [FACT] Ministers are barred; the term is one year.
- [FACT] They examine demands for grants, referred Bills, annual reports and long-term policy documents.
- [LIMIT] Recommendations are advisory. Bills are not automatically or constitutionally required to be referred.

Visual 29 - DRSC scrutiny loop

```

MINISTRY
| budget demand | Bill | annual report | policy paper
v
DRSC: evidence -> expert/member questions -> cross-party deliberation
|
v
REPORT AND RECOMMENDATIONS
|
+--> Government action-taken response
|
+--> better-informed House debate

```

Weak links: optional referral | one-year term | low attendance |
research constraints | non-binding recommendations

Other high-yield committees

Committee	Core function	Exact control/caution
Committee on Subordinate Legislation	Tests whether delegated rule-making stays within legislative authority	This is the 2018 delegated-legislation answer, not PAC
Ethics Committee	Examines unethical conduct of members	Distinct from privilege
Committee of Privileges	Examines breach of privilege/contempt	Privilege protects institutional function
Committee on Government Assurances	Tracks promises/assurances made by ministers	Follow-up, not financial audit
Business Advisory Committee	Recommends allocation of House time	Does not replace the government's agenda role
Rules Committee	Considers House procedure/rules	House-specific
Committee on Petitions	Processes qualifying petitions	Citizen-to-House channel
Welfare of SCs and STs	30 = 20 LS + 10 RS , one-year term, chair appointed by Speaker	Examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation; ministers barred

- [FACT] Ethics and Privileges are separate: unethical conduct need not be a breach of a specific privilege, and privilege proceedings serve institutional functioning.
- [FACT] The Welfare of SCs/STs Committee is a parliamentary committee, not the constitutional National Commissions under Articles 338 and 338A.

16. Rajya Sabha: equal, unequal and exclusive powers

Visual 30 - Power map

Field	Rajya Sabha position relative to Lok Sabha
Ordinary Bills	Equal, subject to joint-sitting mechanism
Constitution Amendment Bills	Equal; each House must separately pass
President and Vice-President elections	Participates under respective constitutional rules
Money Bills	Inferior: recommendation only, fourteen days
Demands for Grants	Discusses but does not vote
Confidence in Union ministry	No removal power; Article 75(3) attaches to Lok Sabha
Joint sitting	Participates, but Lok Sabha's numbers usually dominate
Federal special powers	Rajya Sabha alone initiates Articles 249 and 312

Article 249

- [FACT] By a resolution supported by not less than two-thirds of members present and voting, Rajya Sabha may declare it necessary or expedient in the national interest for Parliament to legislate on a State List matter.
- [FACT] The resolution lasts up to one year and may be renewed; laws continue for six months after the resolution ceases.

Article 312

- [FACT] A two-thirds present-and-voting Rajya Sabha resolution may declare it necessary or expedient in the national interest to create one or more All-India Services common to Union and States.

Visual 31 - Qualified verdict

SECONDARY ON: money + supply + confidence
CO-EQUAL ON: ordinary law + constitutional amendment

DISTINCTIVE ON: continuity + federal revision
EXCLUSIVE ON: Articles 249 and 312

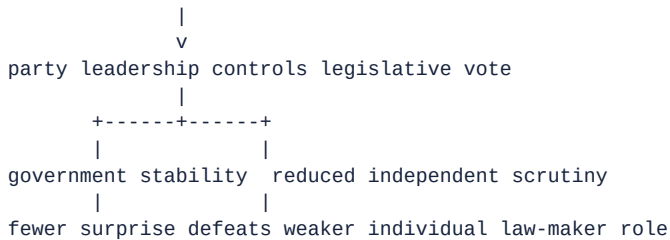
Verdict: supporting second chamber, not subordinate chamber

- [ANALYSIS] Calling Rajya Sabha “secondary” is accurate only for finance and government survival; it is misleading for ordinary law, constitutional amendment and federal functions.
- [LIMIT] Do not add loosely described powers to the list of Rajya Sabha's two exclusive constitutional powers controlled by Core: Articles 249 and 312.

17. Anti-defection, whip and the individual parliamentarian

Visual 32 - Incentive chain

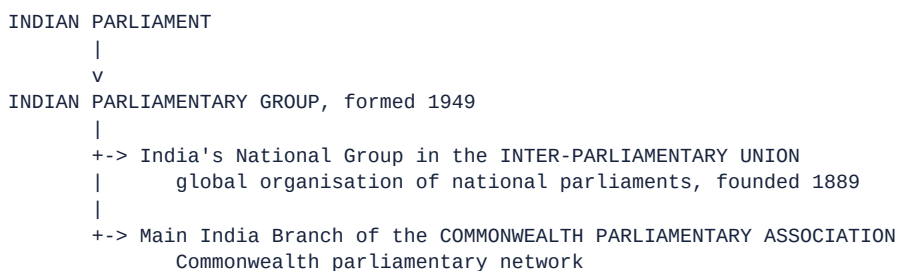
Tenth Schedule threat
voluntarily leaving party | defying whip without condonation



- [FACT] The 52nd Amendment (1985) inserted the Tenth Schedule; the 91st Amendment (2003) deleted the one-third split exception. Only merger supported by at least two-thirds of the legislature party survives.
- [FACT] Party members risk disqualification for voluntarily giving up membership or defying a direction without prior permission and without condonation within fifteen days.
- [FACT] Independents are disqualified on joining any party; nominated members may join within six months but not thereafter without consequence.
- [FACT] *Kihoto Hollohan* (1992) treats the Speaker/Chairman as a tribunal subject to judicial review. *Keisham Meghachandra* (2020) urged ordinarily deciding within about three months and proposed consideration of an independent tribunal.
- [ANALYSIS] The whip stabilises responsible government but turns MPs from deliberators into party vote units when used beyond confidence and core financial matters.
- [LIMIT] Limiting the whip and shifting adjudication are reform proposals, not existing law.

18. Indian Parliamentary Group, IPU and CPA

Visual 33 - Inter-parliamentary network



- [FACT] All MPs may become IPG members. The Lok Sabha Speaker is ex-officio President; the Deputy Speaker and Rajya Sabha Deputy Chairman are ex-officio Vice-Presidents.
- [FACT] IPG supports exchanges, delegations and parliamentary diplomacy.
- [LIMIT] IPG is not a Ministry of External Affairs organ; IPU represents parliaments, not governments; CPA is Commonwealth-specific while IPU is global.

19. Parliamentary decline: diagnosis, counter-evidence and reform

Visual 34 - Decline mechanism

Executive controls most business and legislative drafting
 +
 wide whip and secure majority
 +
 short/uncertain sitting time and disruption
 +
 guillotine, limited committee referral, ordinance or contested Money Bill route
 |
 v
 less member autonomy -> less debate -> thinner scrutiny -> ratification risk

Diagnosis

- [ANALYSIS] **Executive agenda dominance:** the government controls most House business and drafts most legislation.
- [ANALYSIS] **Party dominance:** the Tenth Schedule makes rebellion costly and narrows individual judgement.
- [ANALYSIS] **Time scarcity:** disruptions and limited sittings weaken questions, grants and clause-level debate.
- [ANALYSIS] **Bypass/acceleration:** ordinances, guillotine and overbroad Money Bill classification can reduce bicameral scrutiny.
- [ANALYSIS] **Committee erosion:** optional referral and non-binding recommendations weaken the institution best suited to technical scrutiny.

Counter-evidence

- [FACT] No-confidence, questions, motions, bicameral consent, budget authorisation and committee inquiry remain constitutionally available.
- [FACT] PAC-CAG scrutiny can expose financial irregularity; courts review constitutional boundaries; elections renew political responsibility.
- [ANALYSIS] Decline is therefore not institutional extinction. It is a gap between formal capacity and political use.

Visual 35 - Reform matrix

Problem	Reform direction	Qualification
Too little scrutiny time	Predictable calendar and minimum sitting norms	Preserve genuine emergency flexibility
Weak Bill examination	Default DRSC/Select Committee referral with reasoned exceptions	Avoid an absolute rule that blocks urgency
Overbroad whip	Limit compulsory whip to confidence and essential financial votes	Requires legal/political change
Speaker partisanship concerns	Reasoned rulings, timely defection decisions, independent tribunal debate	Neutrality cannot rest on convention alone
Money Bill misuse risk	Apply Article 110's "only" test strictly and preserve narrow judicial review	Do not erase legitimate fiscal procedure
Weak committee capacity	Longer tenure, research staff, attendance and action-taken follow-up	Reports can remain advisory yet influential
Opposition voice	Protect Question Hour, opposition business and chair conventions	Opposition also bears responsibility for functioning

Qualified verdict: [ANALYSIS] Parliament's problem is not absence of power but uneven conversion of power into scrutiny. Reform should change time, incentives and information, not merely add more devices.

20. Live unit: 106th Amendment, Census 2027 and delimitation

A. Three registers that must never be merged

Visual 36 - Women's reservation status registers

REGISTER 1: ENACTED / INCORPORATED

September 2023 assent; Articles 330A, 332A and 334A in Constitution



REGISTER 2: COMMENCED

16 April 2026 notification under section 1(2)



REGISTER 3: OPERATIONAL RESERVATION

NOT YET

requires publication of relevant first post-commencement census figures

-> delimitation undertaken for this purpose -> reservation takes effect

- [FACT] The 106th Amendment provides one-third reservation for women in Lok Sabha, State Legislative Assemblies and the Delhi Legislative Assembly, including within SC/ST-reserved seats.
- [FACT] It **commenced on 16 April 2026**.
- [FACT] Article 334A(1) makes operationalisation contingent on delimitation undertaken for this purpose after publication of relevant figures of the first census taken after commencement.
- [FACT] Article 334A(2) permits continuance as Parliament may by law determine; Article 334A(3) links rotation to each subsequent delimitation.
- [LIMIT] Quote the duration phrase as **“fifteen years from such commencement”**. Do not derive a 2041 end date because the referent of “such commencement” is contested in commentary.
- [LIMIT] Commencement is not operationalisation; no seat is presently reserved under these provisions.

B. Census 2027 controls

Visual 37 - Trigger sequence

16 Apr 2026: 106th Amendment commences



Census 2027 = first census taken after commencement



notified conduct and reference dates



publication of relevant figures: DATE UNKNOWN



delimitation undertaken for this purpose: DATE UNKNOWN



women's reservation takes effect: DATE UNKNOWN

Census control	Official position	Limit
Houselisting and Housing Census	1 April-30 September 2026 window; each State/UT chooses a fixed 30-day period	Do not claim a single nationwide completion date
Population Enumeration	February 2027 generally; September 2026 in identified snow-bound areas	Enumeration is not publication
Reference date	00:00 on 1 March 2027 generally	Snow-bound reference date differs
Snow-bound reference date	00:00 on 1 October 2026	Keep both reference dates separate
Design	First fully digital census; self-enumeration; caste enumeration announced	Do not predict findings or legal use
Legal frame	Census Act, 1948 and Census Rules, 1990	The census is statutory; Articles 82/334A borrow its figures

- [FACT] Census 2027 is also the first census after 2026 relevant to the 84th Amendment/Article 82 readjustment trigger.
- [LIMIT] Conduct date, reference date and publication date are different. The constitutional trigger turns on **publication**.

C. The defeated 2026 delimitation package

Visual 38 - Legislative event timeline

```

16 APRIL 2026: introduced in Lok Sabha
  Constitution (131st Amendment) Bill
  Delimitation Bill
  Union Territories Laws (Amendment) Bill
  |
17 APRIL 2026: constitutional amendment division
  298 for | 230 against | 528 present and voting
  |
Article 368 tests
  majority of total membership: cleared
  two-thirds present and voting: not cleared (needed about 352)
  |
RESULT: amendment defeated; linked Bills did not pass

```

- [FACT] The amendment Bill proposed raising the Article 81 ceiling from 550 to **850**: up to 815 State seats and 35 UT seats.
- [FACT] It proposed permitting Parliament to determine the census figures used, with an immediate exercise on 2011 Census figures, and sought to advance operationalisation of the women's quota.
- [FACT] 298 votes exceeded a majority of the total elected strength of 543 but fell short of two-thirds of 528 present and voting.
- [ANALYSIS] The episode cleanly proves that a government majority is not an Article 368 amending majority.
- [LIMIT] Every number above belongs only to the defeated Bill/event. Existing Article 81 ceiling remains 550; existing elected Lok Sabha strength remains 543; Article 334A remains unchanged.
- [LIMIT] Do not say the Bill "lost the division": it received more ayes than noes but failed the special-majority threshold.

21. Answer-writing architecture

Visual 39 - Mandatory answer spine

```

CLAIM
directly answer the directive
|
NAMED EVIDENCE
Article / case / committee / amendment / dated official event
|
ANALYSIS
explain mechanism, consequence or significance
|
QUALIFICATION
state counter-evidence, status limit or variation
|
VERDICT
graded answer to the exact question

```

Directive fidelity

Directive	Required operation	Common failure
Discuss	Explain major dimensions with balance	Mere list
Examine	Test the proposition using evidence	One-sided assertion
Evaluate	Apply criteria, strengths and weaknesses, then judge	Description without judgment
To what extent	Give a degree-based answer	Absolute yes/no
Highlight factors and areas	Separate causes from fields of effect	Mixing both
Elucidate	Clarify mechanism with evidence	Generic merits/demerits

Mark-scaled evidence load

Marks/words	Structure	Named evidence target
10 / 150	Thesis -> 2-3 mechanisms -> one qualification -> verdict	2-3 precise Articles/cases/committees
15 / 250	Thesis -> 4-5 dimensions -> counterpoint -> verdict	4-6 named units
20 / 250	Thesis -> architecture -> causes -> consequences -> counterevidence -> reform -> graded verdict	5-8 named units

Reusable answer spines

- **Executive accountability:** Article 75(3) -> questions/discussions -> motions -> budget -> committees -> whip/time limits -> degree-based verdict.
- **Rajya Sabha:** money/confidence subordination -> ordinary/amendment equality -> Articles 249/312 -> continuity/federal role -> supporting-not-subordinate verdict.
- **Speaker:** Articles 93-97 -> rule/Money Bill/defection powers -> British convention contrast -> judicial/structural limits -> reform.
- **Committees:** standing/ad hoc -> financial trio -> DRSCs -> usefulness -> advisory/referral weaknesses -> strengthen, not bypass.
- **Decline:** whip -> executive calendar -> guillotine/referral decline -> bypass routes -> counter-instruments -> reforms.
- **Money Bill:** Article 110 "only" -> Article 109 procedure -> Speaker certificate -> *Puttaswamy/Rojer Mathew* -> federal cost -> qualified pending-status verdict.

PART II - Optional Advanced analytical enrichment

A1. Constitutional supremacy versus parliamentary supremacy

Visual 40 - Three levels of authority

CONSTITUTIONAL SUPREMACY

written text + federal distribution + rights + judicial review + basic structure

PARLIAMENTARY CENTRALITY

law, supply, representation, accountability, amendment

EXECUTIVE AGENDA DOMINANCE

government controls most Bills, time and majority management

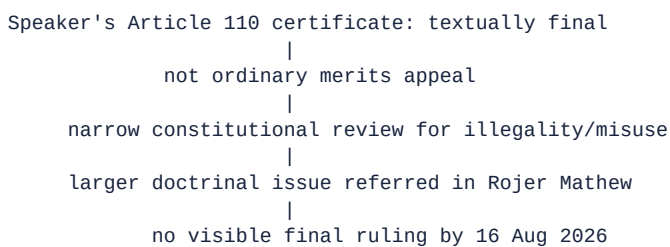
- [ANALYSIS] "Parliamentary supremacy" in Indian GS-II questions usually means effective deliberative and control capacity, not unlimited legal sovereignty.
- [FACT] Parliament cannot enact ordinary law beyond constitutional competence, and Article 368 itself is limited by the basic-structure doctrine.

- [ANALYSIS] Cabinet dominance can marginalise Parliament without transferring constitutional sovereignty to the Cabinet.

A2. Money Bill certification and the unresolved larger-Bench issue

- [FACT] In *K.S. Puttaswamy (Aadhaar)*, 2018, a 4:1 majority upheld the Aadhaar Act's Money Bill route; Chandrachud J dissented.
- [FACT] In *Rojer Mathew v. South Indian Bank* (2019), the Court doubted the earlier Article 110 reasoning and referred the issue to a larger seven-judge Bench.
- [CURRENT] As of 16 August 2026, no visible final decision resolving that larger-Bench issue was located on the official Supreme Court judgment portals.
- [LIMIT] The safe formulation is: **Article 110 calls the Speaker's decision final, but constitutional courts retain narrow review for illegality or constitutional misuse; the larger doctrinal issue remains without a visible final resolution.**

Visual 41 - Judicial-review boundary



A3. Procedure refinements that separate strong answers

- [FACT] A private member may introduce an ordinary Bill; “government Bill” describes sponsor, not a separate constitutional class.
- [FACT] A Financial Bill-I is not a Money Bill: it starts only in Lok Sabha on recommendation, but Rajya Sabha retains full amending/rejecting power and joint sitting is possible.
- [FACT] A Financial Bill-II may originate in either House; recommendation is needed before consideration because expenditure from the Consolidated Fund is involved.
- [FACT] A constitutional amendment deadlock is fatal to the Bill; neither joint sitting nor a suspensive presidential return exists.
- [FACT] A joint sitting already notified survives dissolution, showing that presidential notification changes the lapse position.
- [ANALYSIS] Procedure questions reward classification before narration: identify Bill type first, then origin, recommendation, Rajya Sabha power, deadlock route and assent.

A4. Committees as the realistic deliberative centre

- [ANALYSIS] Televised floors reward party signalling; smaller committees lower visibility costs, allow evidence-taking and make cross-party bargaining easier.
- [ANALYSIS] Their value comes from continuity, specialisation and information, not from power to bind the government.
- [LIMIT] “Mini-Parliaments” is an analytical label. Committees cannot replace plenary passage, confidence or final appropriation.
- [ANALYSIS] The strongest reform is default referral with a public, reasoned urgency exception, backed by research capacity and action-taken tracking.

A5. Concise source and current-control note

- Authoritative Core: Polity/basic/Parliament.md.
- Optional procedure source: Polity/advanced/17_Parliament.md; its stale statement that no 106th Amendment commencement notification was located has been superseded and is not repeated.
- Cross-links used: Polity 11, Polity 16, Anti-Defection, Election Commission, Amendment and Basic Structure, President and Vice-President.
- Official parliamentary control: <https://sansad.in/> and Digital Sansad debates/Bills/committee records.
- Official 7th Session overview: <https://static.pib.gov.in/WriteReadData/specificdocs/documents/2026/apr/doc2026418851201.pdf>.
- Official Census control: <https://censusindia.gov.in/>.
- [LIMIT] Session labels, office holders, committee chairs, committee referrals, live Bill status and litigation status must be rechecked before future present-tense use.
- [LIMIT] No current MPLADS amount is quoted. The stable routed propositions are that MPLADS is a scheme, funds are non-lapsable and utilisation is monitored/inspected through the scheme framework.

PYQ, practice and solved workbook

Solved directly routed Mains PYQs

Provenance rule: The seven 2018-2023 demands are routed by the audited Core owner. The 2024 GS-II Q3 wording is verified in the cross-owned Polity 11/16 packages. Neutral wording is used where exact UPSC wording has not been independently reproduced here.

PYQ-M1. 2018 GS-II Q4 - Usefulness of parliamentary committees, especially the Estimates Committee

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” requires functions, usefulness, limitations and a balanced conclusion.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** use three institutional units, not a catalogue of every committee.

Model answer

Claim: Parliamentary committees are indispensable “working rooms” of Parliament because they preserve detailed scrutiny when plenary time is scarce.

Named evidence: The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members**, excludes ministers and examines budget estimates for economy, efficiency and administrative improvement. It complements the **PAC**, which audits CAG findings after expenditure, and **CoPU**, which specialises in public undertakings. The **24 DRSCs**, each with 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha members, examine demands for grants, referred Bills and ministry reports.

Analysis: Small membership, evidence-taking, continuity and less theatrical party competition allow technical and often cross-party scrutiny. Estimates scrutiny is preventive: it asks whether public money can be spent better before audit identifies failure.

Qualification: Reports are advisory; attendance, research support and Bill referral vary. Estimates recommendations cannot themselves alter grants.

Verdict: Committees do not replace the House, but they make its financial and legislative control credible. Routine referral and stronger follow-up would increase their usefulness.

Examiner note: Exact Estimates-PAC-CoPU differentiation, DRSC evidence and one limitation make this complete rather than descriptive.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named committee units plus a qualified verdict.

PYQ-M2. 2019 GS-II Q15 - Decline of the individual parliamentarian and debate quality

Demand decoding

- “Discuss” requires mechanisms causing decline, surviving opportunities and reforms.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** separate member autonomy, House time and scrutiny quality.

Model answer

Claim: The individual MP's law-making role has declined because party and executive institutions increasingly determine both the vote and the agenda.

Named evidence and analysis: First, the **Tenth Schedule** makes defiance of a party direction potentially disqualifying. This stabilises government but converts many legislative choices into party commands. Second, the executive controls most government business and drafting; limited sitting time, disruption and the **guillotine** can pass demands without discussion. Third, fewer or selective referrals to **DRSCs** remove the main site for clause-level, evidence-based scrutiny. Fourth, ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** Money Bill route can compress prior bicameral deliberation. Finally, the rarity of successful Private Members' Bills signals limited non-government law-making space.

Counter-evidence: MPs still use starred questions, Zero Hour, motions, committee reports, amendments and constituency knowledge. Rajya Sabha scrutiny and opposition-led PAC work can produce institutional effects even without defeating the government.

Qualification: Decline varies with majority size, coalition politics, committee referral and presiding-officer practice; it is not a constitutional disappearance of the MP.

Verdict: The parliamentarian has shifted from autonomous law-maker toward party-linked scrutiniser. Predictable sittings, default committee referral and a whip confined to confidence/core finance would restore deliberation without destabilising government.

Examiner note: The answer explains the causal chain and acknowledges surviving agency; it does not confuse low autonomy with legal powerlessness.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 5 mechanisms, 2 counter-instruments and 3 reforms.

PYQ-M3. 2020 GS-II Q5 - “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” and objectivity

Demand decoding

- Answer both parts: whether the convention operates in India and its implications for objectivity.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** one institutional contrast, three powers, one reform.

Model answer

Claim: The British convention that a Speaker severs party ties and is normally returned unopposed does not operate in India; therefore neutrality rests more on individual conduct than institutional insulation.

Named evidence: Under **Articles 93-97**, the Speaker controls procedure and discipline. The office also certifies a Money Bill under **Article 110**, presides over an **Article 108** joint sitting and decides Tenth Schedule petitions subject to *Kihoto Hollohan*. The Speaker retains party membership and ordinarily contests again on a party ticket.

Analysis: These high-stakes powers can affect bicameralism, government survival and member status. A party-linked career therefore creates a perception of bias even when a decision is legally defensible. Delayed defection rulings and disputed Money Bill certification intensify the concern.

Qualification: Article 94 continuity after dissolution, charged salary and House removal safeguards provide some independence; party origin does not prove actual partisanship.

Verdict: “Once a Speaker, always a Speaker” is aspirational, not Indian practice. Reasoned rulings, political detachment and independent defection adjudication would make objectivity structural.

Examiner note: Direct convention answer plus powers-mechanism-qualification sequence satisfies both limbs.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 3 named powers and one balanced reform.

PYQ-M4. 2020 GS-II Q14 - Rajya Sabha as a supporting organ

Demand decoding

- “Highlight factors and areas” requires separate treatment of causes and fields of subordination.

- **15 marks | 250 words:** avoid the absolute claim that Rajya Sabha is inferior everywhere.

Model answer

Claim: Rajya Sabha is a supporting chamber in finance and confidence, but a co-equal or distinctive chamber in ordinary law, constitutional amendment and federal protection.

Areas of subordination: Under **Articles 109-110**, it can only recommend changes to a Money Bill within fourteen days. It cannot vote demands for grants, and **Article 75(3)** gives only Lok Sabha the confidence key. In an **Article 108** joint sitting, Lok Sabha's larger numbers usually prevail.

Factors: Direct election gives Lok Sabha stronger popular legitimacy; executive survival is tied to its majority; and disputed use of the Money Bill route can bypass the Upper House. Political disruption and limited referral can further weaken revision.

Counter-evidence: Rajya Sabha has equal power over ordinary Bills and **Article 368** amendments. As a permanent House it supplies continuity. Its two exclusive powers - **Article 249** State List legislation in the national interest and **Article 312** creation of All-India Services - make it a federal gatekeeper. It also shares committee scrutiny and national debate.

Qualification: State representation is population-weighted, not equal-per-State; its federal design is therefore weaker than a senate based on State equality.

Verdict: Rajya Sabha supports Lok Sabha without being subordinate to it. The label is accurate only where the Constitution deliberately prioritises popular control over money and government survival.

Examiner note: Separates "factors" from "areas" and gives a degree-based verdict with Articles 249/312.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; 3 subordinate fields, 4 counterweights and one design caveat.

PYQ-M5. 2021 GS-II Q4 - Extent of Parliament's executive accountability

Demand decoding

- "To what extent" demands a graded judgment, not a list of devices.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** instruments -> limits -> degree-based verdict.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament possesses a comprehensive accountability toolkit, but its effectiveness is conditional on time, information and party incentives.

Named evidence: Starred questions and supplementaries compel ministerial explanation; Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions expose policy failure. **Article 75(3)** enables Lok Sabha no-confidence control. **Articles 112-114** require budget presentation, voting of grants and appropriation. **PAC-CAG** audit and **DRSC** scrutiny extend control beyond the floor.

Analysis: These instruments cover the full administrative cycle - information, authorisation, ongoing criticism, financial audit and ultimate removal.

Qualification: A secure majority and the Tenth Schedule make government defeat unlikely. Disruptions, the guillotine, limited sitting days, selective committee referral and ordinances can weaken scrutiny.

Verdict: Accountability is constitutionally strong but behaviourally uneven: Parliament usually extracts information and audit, yet only exceptionally threatens executive survival. Protected scrutiny time and stronger committees would narrow the gap.

Examiner note: "Extent" is answered explicitly by distinguishing routine oversight from survival control.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 evidence families and 4 limitations.

PYQ-M6. 2021 GS-II Q15 - Working of DRSCs in enforcing executive control

Demand decoding

- "Evaluate" requires criteria: design, performance, weaknesses and final assessment.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** exact composition is essential.

Model answer

Claim: DRSCs are Parliament's most capable instrument of continuous ministry-wise oversight, but they enforce control through information and persuasion rather than binding command.

Named evidence: Introduced as **17 committees in 1993** and restructured to **24 from 2004**, each now has **31 members - 21 Lok Sabha and 10 Rajya Sabha**; sixteen are Lok Sabha-secretariat serviced and eight Rajya Sabha-secretariat serviced. Ministers are barred. They examine demands for grants, referred Bills, annual reports and long-term policy.

Analysis: Their smaller forum permits evidence-taking, clause scrutiny, technical learning and cross-party consensus away from floor grandstanding. Demand-for-grants reports connect policy priorities with spending; Bill reports improve legal design; action-taken reports sustain follow-up.

Weaknesses: Referral is not automatic, recommendations are non-binding, terms are only one year, attendance and research support can be weak, and the government may provide delayed or formalistic responses. Major Bills passed without referral show that effectiveness depends on executive and presiding-officer choices.

Qualification: Non-binding status is not uselessness: reasoned reports shape debate, media and later policy, while final law and supply must remain with the House.

Verdict: DRSCs work effectively when used, but are under-used. Default referral, longer specialisation, expert staff and public reasons for bypass would convert potential into systematic control.

Examiner note: Exact 1993/2004 and 21+10 controls, functions and enforceability distinction produce an evaluative answer.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 235-250 words; 4 functions, 5 weaknesses and 4 reforms.

PYQ-M7. 2023 GS-II Q16 - Committee structure and role of financial committees

Demand decoding

- "Explain the structure" requires classification before evaluating the financial arm.
- **15 marks | 250 words:** use exact committee compositions.

Model answer

Claim: Parliament's committee system combines permanent subject/House oversight with task-specific inquiry; its financial committees operationalise the constitutional power of the purse.

Structure: **Standing committees** include financial committees, 24 DRSCs, House-management committees and oversight bodies such as Subordinate Legislation, Privileges, Ethics, Government Assurances and Welfare of SCs/STs. **Ad hoc committees** include Select/Joint Committees on Bills and JPCs formed for a specified inquiry.

Named financial evidence: The **PAC** has **22 members (15 LS + 7 RS)**, is conventionally chaired by the Opposition and examines CAG reports after expenditure. The **Estimates Committee** has **30 Lok Sabha members only** and seeks economy and administrative improvement before or during expenditure planning. **CoPU** has **22 members (15+7)** and specialises in public undertakings. Ministers are barred from all three.

Analysis: Estimates supplies prospective efficiency scrutiny, PAC retrospective legality/regularity scrutiny and CoPU institution-specific commercial accountability. DRSC examination of demands bridges these stages.

Qualification: Reports are advisory, PAC ordinarily avoids questioning policy itself and referral/follow-up may be weak.

Verdict: The structure substitutes depth for scarce floor time; its financial arm closes the authorisation-audit loop but needs stronger research and action-taken enforcement.

Examiner note: Begins with the required architecture, then explains rather than merely names each financial committee.

Mark/word discipline: 15 marks; target 230-250 words; classification plus exact 22/30/22 evidence.

PYQ-M8. 2024 GS-II Q3 - Cabinet growth and marginalisation of parliamentary supremacy

Demand decoding

- “Elucidate” requires a mechanism showing how cabinet growth affects Parliament.
- “Parliamentary supremacy” must mean effective control/deliberation, not UK-style legal sovereignty.
- **10 marks | 150 words:** three mechanisms, correctives and qualified verdict.

Model answer

Claim: The cabinet remains responsible to Lok Sabha under **Article 75(3)**, yet fusion of executive and legislature can let a disciplined cabinet majority dominate the institution meant to control it.

Named evidence and analysis: The Tenth Schedule whip reduces independent voting; the government controls most Bills and House time; guillotining demands, selective DRSC referral and compressed debate weaken scrutiny. Ordinances under **Article 123** and an overbroad **Article 110** route can reduce prior legislative and bicameral examination. PMO-centred coordination may add prime-ministerial dominance over cabinet dominance.

Qualification: Parliament still authorises supply, may remove the ministry, asks questions and uses PAC-CAG/DRSC scrutiny. Courts enforce constitutional limits and elections renew responsibility.

Verdict: Cabinet growth has marginalised Parliament's deliberative and control functions, not transferred constitutional sovereignty. Predictable sittings, routine committee scrutiny and narrower whip use can restore responsible fusion.

Examiner note: It clarifies the proposition, proves the mechanism and avoids the sovereignty trap.

Mark/word discipline: 10 marks; target 145-155 words; 4 mechanisms, 3 correctives and one reform verdict.

Routed Parliament Prelims demand laboratory

Answer-key provenance: For 2018-2023, official keys are not held locally. For 2024-2025, official Set-A keys are held locally but no option letter is reproduced or inferred here. For 2026, the locally held Set-A keys are provisional and no option letter is reproduced or inferred. Each entry therefore gives the doctrinal solution and elimination logic, not an invented key.

2018-2023 routed demands: 11

Year/ Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2018 Q1	First Lok Sabha opposition/LoP history	LoP is a statutory office under the 1977 Act; Core applies the one-tenth recognition threshold. Distinguish largest opposition party from recognised LoP.	Official key unavailable locally; do not invent first-party identity without exact source.
2018 Q20	Committee scrutinising delegated legislation	Committee on Subordinate Legislation examines whether delegated powers are properly exercised.	Not PAC, Estimates or Government Assurances.
2018 Q31	Money Bill definition/procedure	Article 110 “only” test; Lok Sabha origin; President recommendation; Speaker certificate; Rajya Sabha recommendations within 14 days; no joint sitting.	Official key unavailable locally; resolve each statement doctrinally.
2019 Q49	Parliament Disqualification Act/office of profit	Articles 102/103 plus Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959; President decides a sitting-member question after ECI opinion.	Exemption is office-specific, not a general immunity.
2019 Q69	Committees reviewing independent regulators	No single general “regulators committee”; relevant DRSC scrutinises the regulator with its parent ministry and subject field.	Committee jurisdiction follows ministry/subject allocation.
2020 Q2	Rajya Sabha powers equal to Lok Sabha	Equal on ordinary Bills, constitutional amendments and specified elections; unequal on Money Bills, demands and confidence; RS alone initiates Articles 249/312.	Avoid absolute equal/unequal statements.
2020 Q3	MPLADS inspection/carry-forward	MPLADS is a scheme; funds are non-lapsable and carry forward; utilisation is monitored/inspected under the scheme framework.	No current per-MP rupee amount is quoted without live official verification.
2020 Q20	Sessions, summoning and minimum sittings	President summons under Article 85; gap between sessions cannot exceed six months; no constitutional minimum sitting-day count.	Three named sessions are convention, not constitutional compulsion.
2022 Q15	Exclusive Lok Sabha powers	Money Bill origin/certification route, voting demands and holding confidence key are Lok Sabha domains; distinguish from shared legislative powers.	RS has separate Articles 249/312 powers.
2022 Q20	Deputy Speaker election and powers	House elects under Article 93; when presiding, Deputy has Speaker's powers and casting vote; answerable to House, not Speaker; no constitutional deadline.	Do not assume a current vacancy without verification.
2023 Q37	Finance Bill and Money Bill procedure	Money Bill is the narrow Article 110 subset. Financial Bill-I starts in LS on recommendation but RS has full power; Financial Bill-II may start in either House and recommendation is needed before consideration.	“All Money Bills are Financial Bills, not vice versa.”

2024-2025 routed demands: 7

Year/ Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2024 Q68	Article 109/Money Bill and Rajya Sabha	RS cannot reject/amend; it recommends within 14 days; LS may reject recommendations; no return means deemed passage in LS form.	Official Set-A key exists locally; no option letter recorded here.
2024 Q80	Lok Sabha Ethics Committee	Examines unethical conduct of members; distinct from Privileges Committee, which addresses privilege/contempt.	Do not merge ethical misconduct and institutional privilege.
2024 Q81	Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam	106th Amendment: Arts 330A/332A/334A; enacted 2023, commenced 16 Apr 2026, reservation not operational pending publication -> delimitation sequence.	Official key exists; current status updated beyond exam date. No 2041 calculation.
2024 Q93	Speaker during removal resolution	Article 96: Speaker does not preside; may speak and vote in first instance, but no casting vote in that proceeding.	Removal requires effective majority and 14 days' notice.
2024 Q94	Bill lapse on dissolution	Lapses if pending in LS or passed LS/pending RS; survives if pending only in RS, awaiting assent, returned, or joint sitting notified.	Apply status, not a blanket rule.
2024 Q95	Prorogation/dissolution	Both are President's acts under Article 85; prorogation ends session and Bills survive; dissolution ends LS life; adjournment is chair's act.	RS is never dissolved.
2025 Q87	Speaker after dissolution/party resignation	Speaker continues until immediately before new House first sitting; Indian Speaker need not resign party membership.	Official Set-A key exists; no option letter recorded here.

2026 routed demands: 2

Year/ Q	Demand	Doctrinal resolution	Provenance/limit
2026 Q58	Starred, unstarred and supplementary questions	Starred: oral and supplementary allowed; unstarred: written and no supplementaries; supplementary is follow-up to oral answer; short-notice is a distinct urgent oral category.	Local Set-A key is provisional; no option letter recorded or inferred.
2026 Q59	Welfare of SCs/STs Committee	30 members = 20 LS + 10 RS; one-year term; chair appointed by Speaker; ministers barred; examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation.	Parliamentary committee, not the constitutional Commissions. Provisional-key caution applies.

Original MCQ loop - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

OM1. Constitutional composition

Parliament under Article 79 consists of:

A. President, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha B. Prime Minister, Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha C. President and Lok Sabha only D. Rajya Sabha and Lok Sabha only

Answer: A. [FACT] The President is an integral organ of Parliament though not a member of either House.

OM2. Rajya Sabha election

Which correctly describes election of elected Rajya Sabha members from States?

A. Direct FPTP through territorial constituencies B. Proportional representation by single transferable vote through elected MLAs C. List proportional representation through all adults D. Nomination by Governors after Assembly consultation

Answer: B. [FACT] Elected MLAs form the electorate; the 2003 statutory change introduced open ballot.

OM3. Seat-freeze extension

Which amendment extended readjustment until publication of figures of the first census taken after 2026?

A. 42nd Amendment B. 61st Amendment C. 84th Amendment D. 87th Amendment

Answer: C. [FACT] The 42nd began the freeze; the 84th extended it; the 87th changed the boundary-readjustment census basis to 2001.

OM4. Lok Sabha nomination

Which statement is correct?

A. The President may presently nominate two Anglo-Indians to Lok Sabha. B. Lok Sabha has twelve nominated members. C. Anglo-Indian nomination was converted into Rajya Sabha nomination. D. The 104th Amendment ended the Anglo-Indian nomination provision for Lok Sabha.

Answer: D. [FACT] Present Lok Sabha composition has no nominated Anglo-Indian members.

OM5. Article 84

Which is a constitutional qualification for Parliament membership?

A. Citizenship of India B. Prior legislative experience C. Graduation from a recognised university D. Residence for ten years in the represented State

Answer: A. [FACT] Citizenship, prescribed oath, minimum age and statutory qualifications form the gate.

OM6. Sitting-member disqualification

Who decides an Article 102(1) question concerning a sitting MP?

A. Speaker acting alone B. President after obtaining the Election Commission's opinion C. Supreme Court in original jurisdiction D. Returning Officer

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 103 creates the President-ECI decision route.

OM7. Leader of Opposition

Which statement best reflects the Core control?

A. LoP is a purely constitutional office named in Article 75. B. The largest opposition leader automatically becomes LoP in all circumstances. C. LoP is statutory under the 1977 Act and recognition practice uses a one-tenth threshold. D. LoP is appointed by the President.

Answer: C. [FACT] Distinguish the statutory recognised office from the political leader of the largest opposition party.

OM8. Prorogation

Prorogation:

A. Ends the life of Lok Sabha. B. Is ordered by the Speaker. C. Causes every pending Bill to lapse. D. Ends a session through presidential action while pending Bills generally survive.

Answer: D. [FACT] Adjournment is by the chair; dissolution, not prorogation, ends Lok Sabha.

OM9. Starred question

A starred question ordinarily:

A. Receives an oral answer and permits supplementary questions. B. Receives only a written answer. C. Cannot concern a ministry. D. Is identical to Zero Hour.

Answer: A. [FACT] Oral follow-up makes starred questions the principal live cross-examination device.

OM10. No-confidence motion

Which is correct?

- A. It can be moved in either House. B. It belongs only to Lok Sabha and needs support of 50 members for admission. C. It must specify charges against each minister. D. Its defeat dissolves Rajya Sabha.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 75(3) ties collective responsibility to Lok Sabha; reasons need not be stated.

OM11. Speaker after dissolution

On dissolution of Lok Sabha, the Speaker:

- A. Vacates immediately with all members. B. Continues for six months. C. Continues until immediately before the first sitting of the new Lok Sabha. D. Becomes a Rajya Sabha officer.

Answer: C. [FACT] Article 94 preserves institutional continuity.

OM12. Speaker's removal resolution

While a resolution for the Speaker's removal is considered:

- A. The Speaker presides and uses only a casting vote. B. The Deputy Speaker cannot preside. C. The Speaker cannot enter the House. D. The Speaker does not preside, may vote in the first instance and has no casting vote.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 96 removes the conflict in presiding, not the member's right to participate.

OM13. Sita Soren

The 2024 seven-judge ruling establishes that:

- A. Legislative privilege does not immunise acceptance of a bribe for speech or vote. B. All parliamentary speech may be criminally prosecuted. C. Article 105 has been invalidated. D. Only actual voting, not bribe acceptance, can complete bribery.

Answer: A. [FACT] The offence is complete on acceptance; bona fide speech/vote immunity survives.

OM14. Ordinary Bill deadlock

Which is a recognised Article 108 trigger?

- A. Rajya Sabha recommends changes to a Money Bill. B. The second House rejects an ordinary Bill or the Houses finally disagree. C. States refuse to ratify an amendment. D. President returns a Bill.

Answer: B. [FACT] Eligible deadlocks include rejection, final disagreement and specified delay; Money and amendment Bills are excluded.

OM15. Money Bill

Which condition is essential?

- A. It may include any policy matter if taxation is also present. B. Rajya Sabha must consent within fourteen days. C. It must contain only Article 110 matters and incidental provisions. D. A joint sitting resolves disagreement.

Answer: C. [FACT] "Only" is the classification firewall; Rajya Sabha recommendations are non-binding.

OM16. Financial Bill-II

Which statement is correct?

- A. It is always a Money Bill. B. It can originate only in Lok Sabha. C. Rajya Sabha has recommendation-only power. D. It may originate in either House, with presidential recommendation required before consideration.

Answer: D. [FACT] Article 117(3) differs from both Money Bill and Financial Bill-I.

OM17. Joint-sitting history

How many joint sittings had been held according to the controlled Core?

- A. Three B. Four C. Five D. One

Answer: A. [FACT] Dowry 1961, Banking Service 1978 and POTA 2002.

OM18. Bill lapse

Which Bill lapses on Lok Sabha dissolution?

- A. Bill pending in Rajya Sabha and never passed by Lok Sabha B. Bill passed by Lok Sabha but pending in Rajya Sabha C. Bill passed by both Houses awaiting assent D. Bill for which joint sitting was notified

Answer: B. [FACT] It carries the expired Lok Sabha's unfinished mandate.

OM19. Charged expenditure

Charged expenditure on the Consolidated Fund:

- A. Is neither discussed nor voted. B. Is voted by both Houses. C. May be discussed but is not submitted to vote. D. Is voted only by Rajya Sabha.

Answer: C. [FACT] The non-votable character protects specified constitutional expenditures while allowing discussion.

OM20. Token cut

A Token Cut Motion reduces a demand by:

- A. Re 1 B. The full disputed amount C. Ten per cent D. Rs 100

Answer: D. [FACT] Re 1 is Policy Cut; Token Cut ventilates a specific grievance.

OM21. Public Account

Which fund does not require parliamentary appropriation for withdrawal?

- A. Public Account of India B. Consolidated Fund of India C. Contingency Fund after recoupment D. Every constitutional fund requires identical appropriation

Answer: A. [FACT] Public Account contains money held in trust; Consolidated Fund withdrawal requires appropriation.

OM22. PAC

Which correctly describes PAC?

- A. 30 Lok Sabha members; prospective estimates scrutiny B. 22 members (15 LS + 7 RS); examines CAG reports; Opposition chair by convention C. 22 members; examines only private corporations D. 31 members; every ministry has a separate PAC

Answer: B. [FACT] PAC is retrospective audit scrutiny; ministers are barred.

OM23. Estimates Committee

Which is correct?

- A. It has seven Rajya Sabha members. B. It is conventionally chaired by the Opposition. C. It has 30 Lok Sabha members and examines economy/efficiency in estimates. D. It decides whether expenditure was legally authorised after the fact.

Answer: C. [FACT] PAC handles post-expenditure CAG audit; Estimates is Lok Sabha-only and prospective.

OM24. DRSC composition

Each DRSC has:

- A. 30 members: 20 LS + 10 RS B. 22 members: 15 LS + 7 RS C. 31 members: 20 LS + 11 RS D. 31 members: 21 LS + 10 RS

Answer: D. [FACT] There were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; 16 are LS-serviced and 8 RS-serviced.

OM25. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee

Which is correct?

- A. It has 30 members (20 LS + 10 RS) and examines NCSC/NCST reports and Article 335 representation. B. It is the same institution as the NCSC. C. It has only Lok Sabha members. D. Ministers must constitute half its membership.

Answer: A. [FACT] It is a standing parliamentary committee; ministers are barred.

OM26. Rajya Sabha's exclusive powers

The controlled pair is:

A. Articles 110 and 123 B. Articles 249 and 312 C. Articles 75 and 113 D. Articles 108 and 111

Answer: B. [FACT] Rajya Sabha initiates national-interest State List legislation and creation of All-India Services.

OM27. Anti-defection merger

Which threshold supports the surviving merger exception?

A. One-third of the House B. Half of members present C. At least two-thirds of the legislature party D. Unanimous party membership

Answer: C. [FACT] The 91st Amendment deleted the former one-third split defence.

OM28. Nominated member under Tenth Schedule

Which statement is correct?

A. A nominated member can never join a party. B. A nominated member may join at any time without consequence. C. The rule is identical to that for an independent. D. A nominated member may join within six months; joining after that can disqualify.

Answer: D. [FACT] An independent is disqualified upon joining any party.

OM29. IPG

The Indian Parliamentary Group:

A. Is India's National Group in the IPU and main India Branch of the CPA. B. Is a wing of the Ministry of External Affairs. C. Represents governments at the United Nations. D. Is limited to Rajya Sabha members.

Answer: A. [FACT] IPG organises parliamentary exchange; IPU is global and CPA Commonwealth-specific.

OM30. 106th Amendment status

As of 16 August 2026:

A. The Act has not commenced. B. It commenced on 16 April 2026, but the reservation remains non-operational pending the Article 334A sequence. C. One-third of current Lok Sabha seats are already reserved. D. The quota necessarily ends in 2041.

Answer: B. [FACT] Commenced and operational are different registers; no end year should be derived.

OM31. Census trigger

What must occur immediately before delimitation can switch on the Article 334A reservation sequence?

A. Completion of houselisting alone B. Reference date of 1 March 2027 C. Publication of the relevant figures of the first post-commencement census D. Passage of an ordinary resolution

Answer: C. [FACT] Enumeration/reference dates are not publication dates.

OM32. 2026 delimitation package

Which statement is correct?

A. Lok Sabha's ceiling is now 850. B. Delimitation must now use the 2011 Census. C. The package created a binding precedent. D. The 131st Amendment Bill proposed 850 but was defeated for want of the Article 368 special majority.

Answer: D. [FACT] 298:230 cleared the total-membership limb but not two-thirds of 528 present and voting.

OM33. Money Bill judicial status

Which is the safest current formulation?

A. Article 110 says final, but narrow constitutional review remains and the *Rojer Mathew* larger issue has no visible final resolution as of 16 August 2026. B. Speaker certification is wholly immune from courts. C. *Rojer Mathew* finally

invalidated all Money Bills. D. *Puttaswamy* unanimously settled every Article 110 issue.

Answer: A. [FACT]/[CURRENT] The formulation preserves textual finality, narrow review and pending-status caution.

OM34. Deputy Speaker

Which statement is correct?

A. The Deputy Speaker is appointed by the Speaker. B. The House elects the Deputy Speaker, who has the Speaker's powers when presiding. C. The Constitution fixes a thirty-day election deadline. D. The office automatically falls vacant on every adjournment.

Answer: B. [FACT] Article 93 says "as soon as may be" but supplies no numerical deadline.

OM35. Parliamentary reform

Which reform most directly improves clause-level legislative scrutiny?

A. Abolishing Rajya Sabha B. Expanding every whip to every vote C. Default committee referral with reasoned urgency exceptions D. Treating every Bill as a Money Bill

Answer: C. [ANALYSIS] It targets the point where evidence and legal text can be tested without destroying emergency flexibility.

OM36. MPLADS

Which statement follows the controlled routed demand?

A. MPLADS is a constitutional entitlement. B. Its funds necessarily lapse at year-end. C. The current annual amount may be quoted without checking. D. It is a scheme with non-lapsable funds; current rupee amount requires live official verification.

Answer: D. [FACT]/[LIMIT] Stable scheme characteristics can be stated; live amounts cannot be guessed.

Remedial MCQs - strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation

RM1. President and membership

Which correction is accurate?

A. The President is an integral part of Parliament but not a member of either House. B. The President is a nominated Rajya Sabha member. C. Parliament excludes the President. D. The President votes in joint sittings.

Answer: A. The Article 79 architecture distinguishes institutional membership from being an integral constitutional organ.

RM2. Session rule

The Constitution requires:

A. Exactly three sessions every year B. No more than six months between the relevant sittings of successive sessions C. At least 100 Lok Sabha sitting days D. A Winter Session every November

Answer: B. Budget/Monsoon/Winter are conventions; Article 85 supplies the six-month ceiling, not a sitting-day quota.

RM3. Prorogation trap

What ordinarily happens to a pending Bill on prorogation?

A. It lapses if introduced by a private member. B. It becomes an ordinance. C. It survives. D. It goes automatically to joint sitting.

Answer: C. Prorogation ends a session; dissolution creates the selective lapse rules.

RM4. Speaker removal

Which statement is correct?

A. Removal uses a simple majority of members present and voting. B. No advance notice is required. C. Speaker must preside over the resolution. D. Removal needs a majority of all the then members after fourteen days' notice.

Answer: D. This is an effective majority; Article 96 separately bars the Speaker from presiding.

RM5. Financial Bill-I trap

A Financial Bill-I:

A. Starts only in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation, but Rajya Sabha retains full legislative power. B. Is always subject to the fourteen-day recommendation rule. C. Cannot go to joint sitting. D. Contains only Article 110 matters.

Answer: A. The presence of other matters takes it outside the narrow Money Bill procedure.

RM6. Joint-sitting exclusion

Which pair has no joint-sitting route?

A. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-I B. Money Bill and Constitution Amendment Bill C. Ordinary Bill and Financial Bill-II D. Government Bill and Private Member's Bill

Answer: B. Money Bills have Article 109 procedure; amendments require separate Article 368 passage.

RM7. Committee-number trap

Which statement is correct?

A. DRSCs were 24 from their introduction in 1993. B. Estimates Committee has 15 LS and 7 RS members. C. DRSCs were 17 in 1993 and 24 from 2004; each has 21 LS and 10 RS members. D. Welfare of SCs/STs Committee has 31 members.

Answer: C. The standard distractors wrongly backdate 24 or swap the 21+10 composition.

RM8. Privilege trap

After *Sita Soren*:

A. No speech in Parliament is protected. B. Members have immunity for a bribe if they later vote. C. Article 105 was repealed judicially. D. Bribery lacks privilege immunity, while bona fide speech/vote protection remains.

Answer: D. The judgment targets the separate criminal bargain, not legislative freedom of debate.

RM9. Rajya Sabha status

Which statement is most accurate?

A. Rajya Sabha is weaker on money/confidence, equal in major legislative fields and exclusive under Articles 249/312. B. Rajya Sabha is inferior in every field. C. Rajya Sabha alone votes demands for grants. D. Rajya Sabha may remove the Union ministry.

Answer: A. A graded comparison is required; blanket equality or inferiority is wrong.

RM10. Women's reservation trap

Which is correct as of 16 August 2026?

A. The Act remains uncommenced. B. The Act commenced, but operational reservation awaits publication-linked delimitation. C. Reservation automatically began with Census houselisting. D. Its end date is conclusively 2041.

Answer: B. Enacted, commenced and operational are three separate registers.

RM11. 2026 Bill arithmetic

The 131st Amendment Bill failed because:

A. It received fewer ayes than noes. B. It failed the total-membership-majority limb. C. It cleared a simple majority but failed two-thirds of members present and voting. D. Rajya Sabha rejected it after Lok Sabha passage.

Answer: C. 298 exceeded half of 543 but not two-thirds of 528; it never reached Rajya Sabha.

RM12. Deputy Speaker status

Which wording is safest?

A. The Deputy Speaker's office is permanently abolished. B. The Constitution requires election within thirty days. C. The office is certainly vacant on 16 August 2026. D. The 17th Lok Sabha had no Deputy Speaker; present status must be verified before asserting a current vacancy.

Answer: D. Date-qualified institutional claims avoid converting past vacancy into an unverified present fact.

Original solved Mains practice

M1. Explain how the constitutional design of parliamentary sessions both enables and limits executive accountability. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: "Explain how" requires a mechanism, not merely definitions. Cover summoning rule, devices and the weak sitting-day floor.

Model solution

Claim: Session design keeps the executive periodically answerable but leaves the intensity of accountability to political control of the calendar.

Named evidence: **Article 85** prevents more than six months between sessions, ensuring at least two annual opportunities for scrutiny. Within sittings, starred questions, supplementaries, Zero Hour, Calling Attention and motions demand explanation; **Article 75(3)** allows Lok Sabha to test confidence.

Analysis: Periodic summoning prevents indefinite executive rule without Parliament, while oral questions and motions convert presence into public responsibility.

Qualification: The Constitution fixes no minimum sitting days and does not mandate three named sessions. Executive influence over summoning, disruption and loss of Question Hour may satisfy Article 85 while weakening real scrutiny.

Verdict: The design guarantees recurrence, not adequacy. A predictable calendar and protected accountability time would convert the six-month floor into effective control.

Examiner comment: Strong because Article 85 is linked to actual devices and its design limitation, rather than treated as a calendar fact.

Why this earns marks: Direct thesis; two Articles; mechanism; qualification; feasible reform within 150-word scale.

M2. Legislative privilege is a functional immunity, not a personal impunity. Discuss with reference to *Sita Soren*. (10 marks, 150 words)

Demand decoding: Define function, apply the case and preserve the surviving immunity.

Model solution

Claim: Article 105 protects fearless legislative functioning, not private criminal bargains.

Named evidence: It immunises proceedings for speech and vote in Parliament and protects authorised parliamentary publication. Yet in ***Sita Soren v. Union of India (2024)*** a unanimous seven-judge Bench overruled *P.V. Narasimha Rao* and held that accepting a bribe for a speech or vote attracts no Article 105/194 immunity; bribery is complete on acceptance.

Analysis: The functional-nexus test explains the distinction: debate and voting require autonomy from external litigation, whereas a bribe subverts rather than enables that function.

Qualification: The judgment did not expose bona fide speeches or votes to ordinary suits. Nor does judicial review authorise courts to manage routine House procedure.

Verdict: Privilege remains a shield for institutional independence, but *Sita Soren* correctly denies its conversion into a personal criminal safe harbour.

Examiner comment: Uses exact case proposition and avoids the frequent overstatement that all speech immunity has disappeared.

Why this earns marks: Definition, Article, overruled precedent, functional analysis and precise qualification.

M3. The Money Bill procedure is necessary for popular control of finance but vulnerable to bicameral bypass. Critically examine. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: “Critically examine” requires the rationale, misuse risk, case law and a bounded verdict.

Model solution

Claim: Articles 109-110 legitimately privilege the directly elected Lok Sabha in narrowly fiscal legislation, but overbroad certification can convert financial primacy into general legislative supremacy.

Named evidence: A Money Bill must contain **only** Article 110(1)(a)-(g) matters and incidental provisions. It begins in Lok Sabha on presidential recommendation; Rajya Sabha may only recommend within fourteen days, and no joint sitting exists. The Speaker certifies it, with Article 110 calling the decision final.

Analysis: This design protects supply and taxation from Upper-House obstruction and aligns financial responsibility with the House that can dismiss the ministry. However, classification also removes Rajya Sabha's amendment veto. Adding substantial non-fiscal provisions therefore harms bicameralism and federal revision.

Judicial evidence: *Puttaswamy (Aadhaar)*, 2018 upheld the Aadhaar route by 4:1; *Rojer Mathew* (2019) doubted the reasoning and referred the larger question to seven judges.

Qualification: Textual finality is not ordinary merits appeal, yet narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse remains. As of 16 August 2026 no visible final larger-Bench resolution was located.

Verdict: Popular financial control requires the special procedure, but constitutional fidelity requires strict enforcement of “only”, reasoned certification and narrow review.

Examiner comment: Balances democratic rationale and federal cost, uses both leading cases and preserves current-status caution.

Why this earns marks: Article -> mechanism -> consequence -> cases -> qualification -> reform verdict.

M4. Parliament's power of the purse is exercised through a chain, not a single budget vote. Analyse. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Build the complete authorisation-to-audit cycle and identify weak links.

Model solution

Claim: Financial control is a sequence of disclosure, deliberation, authorisation, expenditure and audit rather than one annual approval.

Named evidence and analysis: **Article 112** requires the Annual Financial Statement and distinguishes charged from voted expenditure. Under **Article 113**, Lok Sabha alone votes demands for grants, using Policy, Economy and Token Cut Motions. DRSCs examine ministry demands before voting, though the **guillotine** may pass undiscussed demands. **Article 114** then requires an Appropriation Act before withdrawal from the Consolidated Fund, while the Finance Bill enacts taxation. **Articles 115-116** provide supplementary, additional, excess grants, vote on account, vote of credit and exceptional grants. After spending, the **CAG** audits and the **PAC** examines reports; excess expenditure is regularised only after this post-facto scrutiny.

Qualification: Rajya Sabha discusses but does not vote demands. Charged expenditure is discussed but not voted. Public Account withdrawal is outside appropriation. Majority discipline makes cut-motion success rare, and PAC review is retrospective.

Verdict: The chain is constitutionally comprehensive but only as strong as DRSC time, grant debate and audit follow-up. Protecting these stages matters more than ritual budget passage.

Examiner comment: The answer maps the entire cycle and differentiates charged expenditure, Public Account and Rajya Sabha's role.

Why this earns marks: Six named constitutional/institutional units linked analytically rather than listed.

M5. Delimitation after the population freeze is simultaneously a democratic-equality and a federal-fairness problem. Examine with reference to the women's reservation trigger. (15 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Examine both normative claims, then integrate Article 334A and current controls.

Model solution

Claim: Restoring population-proportional representation answers malapportionment but may penalise States that reduced fertility, making delimitation a federal bargain rather than a cartographic exercise.

Named evidence: **Article 81(2)(a)** links State seats to population. The **42nd Amendment** froze allocation on 1971 figures; the **84th Amendment** extended readjustment until publication of the first post-2026 census figures; the **87th** enabled 2001-based boundary readjustment. Because Rajya Sabha is population-weighted rather than equal-per-State, low-growth States lack a US-Senate-type counterweight.

Women's-reservation link: The **106th Amendment** inserted Articles 330A, 332A and 334A. It commenced on **16 April 2026**, but Article 334A requires publication of relevant first post-commencement census figures and delimitation before reservation operates. Census 2027 is the trigger census, yet publication and delimitation dates are unknown.

Counterpoint: Permanent under-representation of populous citizens is itself a democratic deficit; the freeze cannot substitute forever for representation.

Qualification: The defeated 131st Amendment Bill's 850 ceiling and 2011 basis are not law. No State or women's-seat projection is valid.

Verdict: Reform must reconcile vote equality with demographic-performance fairness, possibly through negotiated House design, without forecasting an outcome the Constitution has not yet produced.

Examiner comment: Integrates static freeze law, federal theory and the exact commenced-but-not-operational sequence.

Why this earns marks: Balanced normative analysis with Articles, amendments, current trigger and explicit risk controls.

M6. "Parliament is strong in constitutional instruments but weak in their political use." Critically examine and propose reforms. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Test both halves, cover the full accountability architecture and rank reforms.

Model solution

Claim: Parliament retains formidable powers over law, supply and executive survival, yet majority discipline and scarcity of scrutiny time often convert control into formal ratification.

Strength in instruments: Article 75(3) permits no-confidence removal; questions, motions and debates force explanation. Articles 112-114 require financial disclosure, grant voting and appropriation. Ordinary Bills need bicameral consent; DRSCs provide detailed ministry scrutiny; PAC-CAG review closes the audit loop. Rajya Sabha adds continuity and Articles 249/312.

Weakness in use: The Tenth Schedule discourages independent voting; government controls most business; disruption reduces Question Hour; the guillotine passes demands without debate; Bill referral is optional; ordinances and contested Money Bill routing compress scrutiny. Speaker-linked defection and certification powers create neutrality concerns.

Counter-evidence: Committee consensus, opposition-led PAC work, judicial review and public debate can alter policy even when the government wins every vote. Weakness varies with coalition arithmetic and institutional leadership.

Reform: create a predictable sitting calendar; protect questions and opposition time; make committee referral the default with reasoned urgency exceptions; strengthen research/action-taken review; narrow the whip to confidence/core supply; require timely, reasoned presiding-officer decisions.

Verdict: The constitutional hardware remains sound; political incentives and procedural time are the failing software. Reform should activate existing accountability before inventing new devices.

Examiner comment: Covers instruments, causal limits, counterevidence and a prioritised reform package within the directive.

Why this earns marks: Eight named evidence units and a memorable but qualified hardware/software verdict.

M7. Evaluate whether Rajya Sabha and parliamentary committees together can compensate for executive dominance of Lok Sabha. (20 marks, 250 words)

Demand decoding: Evaluate two institutions jointly, specify what they can and cannot compensate for, and give a degree-based judgment.

Model solution

Claim: Rajya Sabha and committees can improve revision, information and financial audit, but cannot fully neutralise a disciplined executive majority controlling confidence, supply and House time.

Rajya Sabha contribution: It is equal on ordinary and constitutional amendment Bills, permanent, committee-integrated and capable of federal debate. **Articles 249 and 312** give it exclusive federal initiative. A government lacking an Upper-House majority must negotiate on non-Money legislation.

Committee contribution: The **24 DRSCs (21 LS + 10 RS each)** scrutinise demands, referred Bills and reports; **PAC (15+7)** connects CAG audit to parliamentary accountability; Estimates and CoPU add prospective and undertaking-specific scrutiny. Smaller forums encourage expertise and cross-party consensus.

Limits: Article 109 reduces Rajya Sabha to recommendations on Money Bills; it cannot vote demands or remove the ministry under Article 75(3). Joint-sitting numbers favour Lok Sabha. Committee reports are advisory, Bill referral varies and the executive can control information and follow-up. Overbroad Money Bill use may bypass both Upper-House veto and ordinary committee pressure.

Qualification: Influence is not measured only by government defeat; reports, delay, amendment and public reasons can improve law.

Verdict: Together they are strong compensating correctives but not a counter-government. Strict Article 110 classification, default referral, research capacity and protected scrutiny time are needed for meaningful balance.

Examiner comment: Integrates bicameral and committee mechanisms and defines compensation by scrutiny quality rather than vote defeat alone.

Why this earns marks: Joint institutional evaluation, exact committee evidence, structural limits and reform-linked verdict.

Final consolidated register notes

Article 79 identity card

Parliament = President + Rajya Sabha + Lok Sabha

President: integral, not a member

India: constitutional supremacy, not British legal parliamentary sovereignty

- [FACT] President summons, prorogues, addresses and assents.
- [ANALYSIS] Lok Sabha = popular/financial-confidence chamber; Rajya Sabha = permanent/federal-revising chamber.
- **Trap:** Never define Parliament as the two Houses alone.

Two Houses: composition, election and term

Recall	Rajya Sabha	Lok Sabha
Ceiling	250	550
Core current strength	245 sanctioned	543 elected
Election	MLAs; PR-STV; open ballot	Direct; FPTP
Nomination	12	None
Age	30	25
Term	Member: 6 years; one-third every 2 years	House: normally 5 years
Dissolution	Never	Yes

- [FACT] 104th Amendment ended Anglo-Indian nomination to Lok Sabha.
- [FACT] 2003 Rajya Sabha domicile/open-ballot changes were statutory; *Kuldip Nayar* upheld them.
- **Trap:** Rajya Sabha is population-weighted, not equal-per-State.

Delimitation and freeze chronology

42nd Amdt, 1976 -> freeze on 1971 basis

84th Amdt, 2001 -> defer until relevant first post-2026 census figures are published

87th Amdt, 2003 -> 2001 figures for boundary readjustment

Article 82 -> readjustment authority fixed by Parliament

Article 329(a) -> delimitation law/allotment insulated from court challenge

- [FACT] Four all-India Delimitation Commissions: 1952, 1962, 1972, 2002 Acts.
- [LIMIT] Jammu and Kashmir post-2019 was a distinct statutory exercise.
- [LIMIT] No automatic unfreezing on 1 January 2026 and no lawful State-wise projection.

Membership and disqualification quick card

- **Article 84:** citizenship; oath; 30 RS/25 LS; statutory qualifications.
- **Article 102:** office of profit; court-declared unsound mind; undischarged insolvent; foreign citizenship/allegiance; parliamentary-law disqualification; Tenth Schedule.
- **Article 103:** President decides sitting-member Article 102(1) question after ECI opinion.
- **RPA 1951:** conviction/corrupt practice/dismissal/government contract/government-company office/expense-account grounds.
- **Lily Thomas (2013):** no sitting-member section 8(4) shield; stay conviction, not merely sentence.
- **Trap:** Election petition in High Court and Article 103 reference are distinct routes.

Office of profit and Leader of Opposition

- [FACT] Office-of-profit purpose: prevent executive patronage from compromising legislative independence.
- [FACT] Tests include appointment/removal, remuneration, governmental control and functions.
- [FACT] Parliament (Prevention of Disqualification) Act, 1959 exempts listed offices.
- [FACT] LoP is statutory under the 1977 Act; Core recognition control uses one-tenth.
- [LIMIT] Largest opposition leader and formally recognised LoP may differ.
- **PYQ trap:** Do not invent the first Lok Sabha opposition party without exact verified source.

Session and sitting vocabulary

Term	Controller	Effect
Summoning	President	Calls House/session
Adjournment	Presiding officer	Pauses sitting
Adjournment sine die	Presiding officer	Ends sitting without next date
Prorogation	President	Ends session; Bills survive
Dissolution	President	Ends Lok Sabha life; selective Bill lapse

- **Article 85:** no more than six months between sessions.
- **Article 100(3):** quorum one-tenth; Core recall 55 LS/25 RS.
- **Trap:** No constitutional minimum sitting days; Budget/Monsoon/Winter are conventions.
- [CURRENT] 8th Session of 18th Lok Sabha adjourned sine die 13 August 2026.

Questions and motions memory grid

Starred = oral + supplementaries

Unstarred = written + no supplementaries

Short-notice = urgent, shorter notice, oral

Zero Hour = Indian innovation; not in Rules

Information -> discussion -> censure -> finance -> confidence

- Calling Attention: urgent ministerial statement.
- Half-an-Hour: clarify an earlier answer.
- Short-Duration: discussion without formal vote.
- Adjournment Motion: urgent definite matter, censure, Lok Sabha, 50.
- No-Confidence: Lok Sabha, 50 for admission, no reasons necessary.
- **Article 75(3):** collective responsibility only to Lok Sabha.

Presiding-officer card

- **Speaker:** Articles 93-97; House-elected; resignation to Deputy; removal by effective majority after 14 days.
- **Continuity:** remains after dissolution until immediately before new House first sitting.
- **Article 96:** does not preside over own removal; may vote first instance, no casting vote.
- **Powers:** rules/order; Article 110 certificate; Article 108 joint sitting; Article 100 casting vote; Tenth Schedule.
- **Deputy Speaker:** independently House-elected; full powers when presiding; no constitutional numerical deadline.
- [CURRENT]/[LIMIT] 17th Lok Sabha had no Deputy Speaker; do not assume current 18th Lok Sabha vacancy.
- **Chairman RS:** Vice-President ex officio, not RS member; Deputy Chairman elected by RS.

Privilege and bribery firewall

- **Article 105:** speech/vote immunity and parliamentary publication protection.
- **Breach of privilege:** violation of a specific privilege.
- **Contempt:** wider obstruction of House functioning.
- **Raja Ram Pal (2007):** legislative privilege subject to limited review for illegality.
- **Sita Soren (2024):** seven judges, unanimous; *P.V. Narasimha Rao* overruled; no bribery immunity; offence complete on acceptance.
- **Trap:** *Sita Soren* did not abolish bona fide speech/vote privilege.

Bill procedure compact spine

Introduction -> general discussion -> committee/consideration -> third reading -> second House -> President

- Ordinary Bill: either House; both agree; Article 111 return once possible.

- Private Member's Bill: sponsor category, not separate constitutional Bill class.
- Committee referral: valuable but not constitutionally automatic.

Bill-class firewall

Class	Origin	Rajya Sabha	Joint sitting
Ordinary	Either House	Equal	Yes
Money, Arts 109-110	LS only	14-day recommendations	No
Financial-I, Art 117(1)	LS only	Full	Yes
Financial-II, Art 117(3)	Either House	Full	Yes
Amendment, Art 368	Either House	Equal/separate passage	No

- **Money Bill:** only Article 110 matters + incidental; Speaker certificate.
- **Financial-I:** Article 110 matters plus other matters.
- **Financial-II:** expenditure from Consolidated Fund, but not Article 110 class.
- **Amendment:** total-membership majority + two-thirds present/voting; some also half-State ratification; President must assent.

Money Bill current doctrine

- **Puttaswamy (2018):** Aadhaar route upheld 4:1; dissent challenged it.
- **Rojer Mathew (2019):** larger seven-judge reference.
- [CURRENT] No visible final larger-Bench decision located by 16 August 2026.
- [LIMIT] Safe phrase: Article 110 certificate is textually final but subject to narrow constitutional review for illegality/misuse.

Joint sitting and lapse rules

- **Article 108:** rejection/final disagreement/six-month delay for eligible Bills.
- **Presiding officer:** Lok Sabha Speaker.
- **Only three:** Dowry 1961; Banking Service 1978; POTA 2002.
- **No joint sitting:** Money Bill or constitutional amendment.

LAPSES: pending LS | passed LS, pending RS

SURVIVES: pending RS only | awaiting assent | returned by President | joint sitting already notified

Budget and grant chain

Art 112 AFS -> general discussion -> DRSC ->

Art 113 demands/cuts/guillotine ->

Art 114 Appropriation -> Finance Bill ->

CAG -> PAC -> excess-grant regularisation

- Charged: discussed, not voted.
- Demands: Lok Sabha only; President recommendation.
- Policy Cut: Re 1; Economy Cut: specified amount; Token Cut: Rs 100.
- Article 115: supplementary/additional/excess.
- Article 116: vote on account/vote of credit/exceptional grant.
- **Trap:** supplementary = in-year insufficiency; excess = post-facto overspending.

Constitutional funds

- **Consolidated Fund, Art 266(1):** appropriation required.
- **Public Account, Art 266(2):** appropriation not required.
- **Contingency Fund, Art 267:** unforeseen advance; later recouped.
- **Trap:** Not every public-money withdrawal uses identical procedure.

Executive accountability stack

Questions -> debates/motions -> legislation -> budget ->
DRSC scrutiny -> CAG/PAC audit -> no-confidence -> elections

- [ANALYSIS] Strong instruments: law, supply, information and survival.
- [ANALYSIS] Weak use: whip, majority, executive agenda, disruption, guillotine, limited referral and acceleration routes.
- **Verdict:** textually strong, behaviourally uneven.

Committee numbers that must not be swapped

Committee	Composition	Key function
PAC	22 = 15+7	CAG/post-expenditure
Estimates	30 LS only	Economy/efficiency in estimates
CoPU	22 = 15+7	Public undertakings
DRSC	31 = 21+10	Ministry demands/Bills/reports
Welfare SC/ST	30 = 20+10	NCSC/NCST reports; Article 335

- DRSC chronology: **17 in 1993 -> 24 from 2004.**
- DRSC service: **16 LS Secretariat + 8 RS Secretariat.**
- Ministers barred in financial trio, DRSCs and Welfare SC/ST as controlled by Core.
- Subordinate Legislation, not PAC, scrutinises delegated legislation.
- Ethics ≠ Privileges.
- Consultative Committee ≠ parliamentary committee.

Rajya Sabha graded-power card

- **Equal:** ordinary Bills; Article 368 amendments; major electoral participation.
- **Weaker:** Money Bills; demands for grants; confidence.
- **Numerically weaker:** joint sitting.
- **Exclusive Core pair:** Article 249 and Article 312.
- **Continuity:** permanent House.
- **Verdict:** supporting on money/confidence, co-equal on law/amendment, distinctive on federation.

Anti-defection impact

- **52nd Amendment, 1985:** Tenth Schedule.
- **91st Amendment, 2003:** split deleted; merger only at two-thirds; office/cap reforms.
- Grounds: voluntarily giving up; whip defiance not permitted/condoned within 15 days.
- Independent joins party -> disqualified.
- Nominated joins after six months -> disqualified.
- **Kihoto Hollohan:** Speaker tribunal, reviewable.
- **Keisham Meghachandra:** about three-month norm suggested; independent tribunal proposed.
- [ANALYSIS] Stability gain <-> deliberative autonomy loss.

IPG-IPU-CPA recall

IPG: Indian parliamentary association, 1949
IPG -> India's National Group in IPU
IPG -> main India Branch in CPA
IPU: global national-parliament organisation
CPA: Commonwealth parliamentary network

- Speaker = ex-officio IPG President.
- Deputy Speaker + RS Deputy Chairman = ex-officio Vice-Presidents.

- **Trap:** IPG is not MEA; IPU is not inter-governmental.

Parliamentary decline and reform spine

Diagnosis

1. Executive controls drafting and most time.
2. Whip reduces member independence.
3. Disruption and few sittings reduce questioning.
4. Guillotine passes unexamined grants.
5. Optional committee referral thins legal scrutiny.
6. Ordinance/contested Money Bill routes compress bicameralism.

Counterweights

1. No-confidence and supply.
2. Questions and motions.
3. Rajya Sabha revision.
4. DRSC and PAC-CAG.
5. Judicial review.
6. Elections/public debate.

Priority reforms

1. Predictable calendar and protected scrutiny time.
2. Default Bill referral with reasoned urgency exceptions.
3. Research staff and action-taken monitoring.
4. Narrower whip for confidence/core finance.
5. Timely, reasoned presiding-officer decisions.
6. Strict Article 110 “only” test.

Women's reservation three-register card

Register	Status on 16 Aug 2026
Enacted/incorporated	Yes; assented September 2023; Arts 330A/332A/334A
Commenced	Yes; 16 April 2026
Operational reservation	No

commencement -> first post-commencement census ->
 publication of relevant figures -> delimitation for this purpose ->
 reservation takes effect

- One-third in LS, State Assemblies and Delhi Assembly, including within SC/ST seats.
- Article 334A(2): continuance as Parliament may by law determine.
- Article 334A(3): rotation after each subsequent delimitation.
- **Trap:** Quote “fifteen years from such commencement”; never calculate 2041.

Census 2027 trigger card

- Houselisting window: 1 April-30 September 2026; State/UT-specific 30-day period.
- Population Enumeration: February 2027 generally; September 2026 snow-bound.
- Reference: 1 March 2027 generally; 1 October 2026 snow-bound.
- First fully digital census; self-enumeration; caste enumeration announced.
- Statutory basis: Census Act 1948 and Rules 1990.
- [LIMIT] Publication date unknown -> delimitation date unknown -> reservation-operation date unknown.

Defeated 2026 Bills card

Introduced 16 Apr:

131st Amendment Bill + Delimitation Bill + UT Laws Amendment Bill

Division 17 Apr:

298 for : 230 against; 528 present/voting

total-membership limb cleared

two-thirds present/voting limb failed

Result:

constitutional amendment defeated; linked Bills did not pass

- Proposed 850 ceiling = 815 States + 35 UTs, **Bill text only**.
- Proposed 2011 Census basis = **Bill proposal only**.
- Existing law: ceiling 550; elected 543; Article 334A unchanged.
- **Trap**: A defeated Bill is not law, precedent or forecast.

PYQ routing map

- **Mains direct**: 2018 committees; 2019 MP decline; 2020 Speaker; 2020 Rajya Sabha; 2021 accountability; 2021 DRSCs; 2023 committee architecture.
- **Cross-owned Mains**: 2024 cabinet growth/parliamentary marginalisation.
- **Prelims 2018-2023**: LoP history; Subordinate Legislation; Money Bill; office of profit; regulator oversight; RS powers; MPLADS; sessions; LS exclusive powers; Deputy Speaker; Finance/Money Bill.
- **Prelims 2024-2025**: Money Bill; Ethics; 106th Amendment; Speaker removal; Bill lapse; prorogation/dissolution; Speaker continuity/party.
- **Prelims 2026**: question types; Welfare SC/ST Committee.
- **Provenance**: 2018-2023 keys unavailable locally; 2024-2025 official keys held but option letters not reproduced; 2026 key provisional.

Universal Mains answer checklist

1. Decode directive and every limb
2. State a direct thesis
3. Use mark-scaled named evidence
4. Explain what each evidence unit proves
5. Add counterpoint/status qualification
6. Give a degree-based verdict

- **10 marks**: 2-3 named evidence units.
- **15 marks**: 4-6 named evidence units.
- **20 marks**: 5-8 named evidence units plus reform/graded judgment where demanded.
- **Non-negotiable pattern**: claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification -> verdict.

Final rapid-fire traps

1. President is part of Parliament, not a House member.
2. RS ceiling 250; LS ceiling 550; Core strengths 245/543.
3. Anglo-Indian Lok Sabha nomination is abolished.
4. Freeze waits for publication of relevant post-2026 census figures.
5. No constitutional minimum sitting days.
6. Prorogation ends session; dissolution ends Lok Sabha.
7. Starred questions allow supplementaries; unstarred do not.
8. Zero Hour is not in the Rules.
9. Speaker survives dissolution and does not preside over own removal.
10. Deputy Speaker current status must be verified; 17th Lok Sabha history is not present status.
11. *Sita Soren* removes bribery immunity, not bona fide speech immunity.
12. Money Bill contains only Article 110 matters.

13. Financial Bill-I is not subject to 14-day RS restriction.
14. No joint sitting for Money or amendment Bills.
15. Only three historical joint sittings.
16. Charged expenditure is discussed, not voted.
17. Policy Cut = Re 1; Token Cut = Rs 100.
18. Public Account does not need appropriation.
19. PAC 22; Estimates 30 LS-only; CoPU 22.
20. DRSC: 17 in 1993, 24 from 2004, 31 = 21+10.
21. Welfare SC/ST: 30 = 20+10.
22. RS exclusive Core pair: Articles 249 and 312.
23. Tenth Schedule merger threshold: two-thirds.
24. IPG = IPU National Group + CPA main India Branch.
25. 106th Amendment commenced 16 April 2026; reservation not operational.
26. Census enumeration/reference date is not publication date.
27. Never derive a 2041 women's-reservation end date.
28. 131st Amendment/Delimitation/UT package was defeated, not enacted.
29. *Rojer Mathew* larger issue has no visible final resolution as of 16 August 2026.
30. Never quote a current MPLADS rupee amount without official live verification.